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Cyprus

History Teaching in Cyprus

Chara Makriyianni and Charis Psaltis and Dilek Latif*

1. Historical culture

1.1. History in the public / public history and predominant dialogues in media and politics

The recent history of Cyprus has been marked by multiple conflicts and foreign interventions, which provide the historical context within which the present analysis of historical education should be framed. A basic outline of the island's recent political history, highly contested though it is, is necessary as background. A word of caution regarding the limitations and methodology of this decision is equally necessary. Discussing the history of Cyprus is akin to stepping into a political and academic minefield, given that most works were written by Greek Cypriot, Turkish Cypriot, Greek, Turkish or British authors in periods of intense violence. Most authors, implicitly or explicitly, used history for legitimating their own side's political objectives, and the rejection of others' objectives.[1]

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* We would like to thank Dr. Yiannis Papadakis for his permission to include in this paper excerpts from his analysis of Turkish Cypriot textbooks produced in 2004 and a short historical overview of Cyprus history published in Yiannis Papadakis, *History Education in Divided Cyprus:* A Comparison of Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot Schoolbooks on the "History of Cyprus", *PRIO Report 2*(*2008*) Available at http://www.prio.no/upload/Report-History%20Education%20low.pdf. Our gratitude also goes to Dr Stavroula Philippou and Mrs Rana Zincir Celal for their valuable input in earlier drafts.

[1] For general critiques of the British and Greek Cypriot approaches to the history of Cyprus see: Michael Given "Symbols, Power and the Construction of City-Kingdoms of Archaic and Classical Cyprus" (PhD Diss., University of Cambridge, 1991); Michael Given, "Star of the Parthenon, Cypriot Melange: Education and Representation in Colonial Cyprus," *Journal of Mediterranean Studies* 7, no. 1 (1997): 59-82; Yiannis Papadakis, "Perceptions of History and Collective Identity: A Study of Contemporary Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot Nationalism" (PhD diss., University of Cambridge, 1993), 25-51. For general critiques of Greek Cypriot schoolbooks on the history of Cyprus see: Loris Koullapis, "*Ideologikoi Prosanatolismoi tis Ellinokypriakis Ekpaidevsis me Emphasi sto Mathima tis Istorias*" [Ideological Orientations of Greek Cypriot Education with Emphasis on the Lesson of History], *Syghrona Themata*, nos. 68-69-70 (1998-1999): 276-296; Loris Koullapis, "The Subject of History in the Greek Cypriot Educational System: A Subset of the Greek Nation," in *Clio in the Balkans: The Politics of History Education*, ed. Christina Koullouri (CDRSEE: Thessaloniki, 2002), 406-422; AKTI, *Ekthesi gia ta Vivlia Istorias kai Logotechnias tis Ektis Dimotikou se Schesi me tin Proothisi tis Vias kai tou Ethnikismou* [Report on History and Literature Books of 6th Grade Primary Schools in Relation to Issues of Violence and Nationalism] (AKTI: Nicosia, 2004). For general critiques of Turkish Cypriot approaches to history and of schoolbooks see: Niyazi Kizilyürek, "National Memory and Turkish Cypriot Textbooks," in *Clio in the Balkans: The Politics of History Education,* ed. Christina Koullouri (CDRSEE: Thessaloniki, 2002), 431-442; POST*, Pilot Application for the History and Literature Books of the 5th Grade of the Elementary School* (Nicosia: POST, 2004),[Available at: http://www.postri.org/efp/3.htm] [May 10, 2009]; POST, *Textual and Visual Analyses of Lower Secondary School History Textbooks: Comparative Analysis of the Old and the New Textbooks*, (Nicosia: POST, 2007), [Available at: http://www.postri.org/efp2/3.htm] [May 10, 2009].

Three centuries of Ottoman rule in Cyprus were succeeded by British colonialism in 1878. The 20th century witnessed the gradual rise, first, of Greek nationalism and, later, of Turkish nationalism, with Greek Cypriots supporting *enosis*, the Union of Cyprus with Greece, and Turkish Cypriots demanding *taksim*, the partition of Cyprus. From 1955 the Greek Cypriot struggle was led by an armed organization called EOKA [National Organisation of Cypriot Fighters], and in 1958 Turkish Cypriots set up their own armed group called TMT [Turkish Resistance Organization]. In 1960, Cyprus became an independent state, the Republic of Cyprus, with a population of 80% Greek Cypriots and 18% Turkish Cypriots and a 2% of Maronites, Armenians and Latins (Roman Catholics)[2]. This outcome frustrated both communities' political goals. Both ethnic groups continued to pursue their separate objectives and in 1963 inter-ethnic fighting broke out in Cyprus. This continued intermittently until 1967, with Turkish Cypriots bearing the heavier cost in terms of casualties and around a fifth of their population being displaced. With a military junta[3] rising to power in Greece, the Greek Cypriot leadership gradually edged away from Union with Greece and instead sought to preserve the independence of Cyprus from attempts by Athens to dictate politics and to solve the inter-communal dispute. While armed confrontations between Turkish and Greek Cypriots ceased after 1967, a new conflict developed – this time among Greek Cypriots. With support of the Greek junta, a small group of right-wing extremists calling itself EOKA B staged a coup in 1974 against the island's President, Archbishop Makarios, in order to bring about union (*enosis*), that is annexation of Cyprus to Greece. This led to a military offensive by Turkey dividing the island, followed by population displacements of most Greek Cypriots to the south and Turkish Cypriots northwards. Greek Cypriots suffered the most casualties, missing persons[4] and all other social traumas of war and dislocation, with around one-third of a total of 600,000 Greek Cypriots displaced to the southern side. Around 45,000 Turkish Cypriots were also displaced to the northern side. In 1983, the Turkish Cypriot authorities unilaterally declared the establishment of their own state in northern Cyprus, the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus (TRNC), which has since remained internationally unrecognized except by Turkey.

Depending on the socio-historical context, the goals of history education may range from the inculcation of national identity to the propagation of moral and political positions, the

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[2] According to Article 1, Appendix D of the Constitution of The Republic of Cyprus, 1960 "The State of Cyprus is an independent and sovereign Republic with a presidential regime, the President being Greek and the Vice-President being Turk elected by the Greek and the Turkish Communities *of* Cyprus respectively as hereinafter in this Constitution provided". In constitutional terms, Armenians, Maronites, Latins form religious groups in the Republic of Cyprus who opted for adherence to the Greek Community; they have the right to elect a representative to the Cypriot Parliament.

[3] A series of right-wing military governments ruled Greece from 1967 to 1974. Rule by the military started in the morning of 21 April 1967 with a *coup d'état* led by a group of colonels of the Greek military, and ended in July 1974.

[4] According to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Republic of Cyprus, as a result of the actions of 1974 thousands were killed and till today the fate of approximately 1500 Greek Cypriots and 500 Turkish Cypriots is not known and they are still missing. Most of these cases were submitted for investigation to the Committee on Missing Persons, which operates under the auspices of the United Nations.

exploration of otherness, the development of historical empathy and presentation of diverse viewpoints, or historical analysis and the promotion of historical thinking within the new history approach in history education which aims to develop students understanding of the discipline of history and their historical thinking (developing second order historical concepts).[5] However, in many societies, especially those divided through ethnic-national conflicts, history is often used to propagate a narrative focusing on the suffering of the nation and to legitimate its political goals. The suffering of others is silenced, their historical existence is questioned, and socio-cultural interactions are ignored. This has been how the "History of Cyprus" has been presented in the history schoolbooks of the two parts of the island for years but recently a local controversy started to emerge.

1.1. 2 The recent political controversy around history textbooks in Cyprus

The process of European Enlargement has undeniably become a catalyst for the resolution of Cyprus problem as it took the Cyprus issue out of its lethargic state of 30 years. This Europeanisation process that implicates both Cypriot communities, Greece and Turkey led to the major developments on the Cyprus issue that climaxed with the referendum in 2004. The year 2004 is indeed mostly remembered in Cypriot public memory as the year of the referendum. Still, for the people following closely the developments in history teaching reform in Cyprus across the divide, 2004 was also a year of significant developments. It is to these developments and the public controversy that we will now turn our analysis.

1.1.3 Recent Political Developments in the Greek Cypriot community and reactions in the Media

In 2003, a coalition of centre and left wing parties came to power in the Greek Cypriot community that replaced the previous right wing government.[6] In 2004 the Educational Reform Committee, comprising a group of academics constituted by and working at the request of the government produced a manifesto-report for *educational transforming reform* of the whole Greek Cypriot educational system. In this manifesto, the Committee argued, among other, for ideological re-orientation and restructuring of the educational system since 'the general orientation and ideology in Cypriot education remain largely based on "Greek values" and knowledge'.[7] The manifesto called for a transformation based on the principles of participatory democracy, 'humanistic' and 'neo-humanistic ideology' and argued for 'objectives such as the intercultural and multicultural ideology that connect Cypriot traditions with knowledge of the culture and civilisation of others.'[8] It proposed greater emphasis on the teaching of history

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[5] For comprehensive analyses of the methods and aims of history education see: Keith Barton and Linda Levstik, *Teaching History for the Common Good* (Lawrence Erlbaum: New Jersey, 2004); Peter Seixas, ed., *Theorizing Historical Consciousness* (Toronto: University of Toronto Press, 2004); Peter Sterns, Peter Seixas and Sam Wineburg, eds., *Knowing, Teaching and Learning History: National and International Perspectives* (New York: New York University Press, 2000).

[6] The coalition that supported Tassos Papadopoulos for President, comprised: DIKO (Centre), AKEL (Communist Party), EDEK (Socialist Party), Ecologists (Green Party). Papadopoulos was the President of DIKO.

[7] Educational Reform Committee, 2004, 4.

[8] Educational Reform Committee, 4.

through educational programmes and textbooks that correspond to European methods and values (peaceful coexistence, multiculturalism, respect for difference, and the elimination of chauvinism, nationalism and inter-communal hatred). In addition, the manifesto highlighted the need for pupils to develop an 'addiction'[9] and adherence to multiple narratives and perspectives via courses like Peace Education and Pedagogy of Rapprochement. It suggested the promotion of joint educational programmes and teacher training seminars in cooperation with Turkish Cypriot schools, teachers and pupils to develop a European dimension and rapprochement among all communities towards a peaceful and viable solution of the Cyprus problem.

The manifesto further proposed the establishment of an impartial, joint committee of academics, consisting of Greek-Cypriots and Turkish-Cypriots, for the revision of history textbooks. The established practice of importing history textbooks from Greece was criticised, and local production of textbooks on the history of Cyprus was advocated in accordance with the UNESCO guidelines on history teaching. The committee pointed out that any change, however presupposes parallel adjustments in training and education, and in-service training of teachers.

Three main lines of argument characterised public reaction to the manifesto.[10] One school of thought supported its proposals and the need for debate removed from bias and party-politics.

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[9] 'Addiction' is the exact translation of the word used by authors. However, the phrase 'compulsive habit' could also be deployed.

[10] The following selection of articles from the right-wing daily newspaper *Σημερινή [Simerini]* partly illustrates the public debate and variety of critical standpoints from representatives of organised parties, the press and organisations: Written by the Assistant General Secretary of POED (Cyprus Greek Teachers' Organisation): Yiannis Pegeiotis, Ένα ειρηνικό κίνημα για τη δημόσια προδημοτική εκπαίδευση [A peaceful movement for the public kindergarten education], *Σημερινή,* 10 Φεβρουαρίου 2003, [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [02 December 2005]; written by the President of ΔΗΚΙ (Secondary Teachers' Trade Union of DIKO party), Former President of ΟΕΛΜΕΚ (Organisation of Secondary School Teachers of Cyprus): Takis Gavrielides, Ο θεσμός του συμβούλου και οι μεταρρυθμίσεις [The institution of advisor and reforms], *Σημερινή,* 23 Μαΐου 2004 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 September 2005]; written by Board Member of the Union of Cypriot Students in Athens DRASIS-KES and student at School of Technological Applications of TEI, Athens: Polyvios Papadopoulou, Μετασχηματισμός των Τεχνικών Σχολών [Transformation of technical schools], *Σημερινή,* 30 Σεπτεμβρίου 2004 [Available at http://www.simerini.com.cy] [02 December 2005]; written by Professor of Political Economics and General Director of the Centre for Research and Development of Intercollege: Andreas Theofanous, Η Τριτοβάθμια Εκπαίδευση και το μέλλον [Tertiary education and future], *Σημερινή,* 31 Οκτωβρίου 2004 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 September 2005]; written by the Former Minister of Education and Culture of the Republic of Cyprus: Kleri Aggelidou, Εκπαιδευτικής μεταρρύθμισης σχόλια [Comments on educational reform], *Σημερινή,* 07 Οκτωβρίου 2004 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 October 2004]; written by Associate Professor, University of Cyprus: Mary Koutselini-Ioannidou, Εκπαιδευτική μεταρρύθμιση – Άποψη [Educational reform – Opinion], *Σημερινή,* 14 Νοεμβρίου 2004 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 February 2005]; written by the Executive Secretary of Ecologists (Green Party): Christoforos Theopemptou, Σοφία, παιδεία και συμμετοχή [Wisdom, education and participation], *Σημερινή,* 10 Δεκεμβρίου 2004 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 September 2005]; written by Parliament Member of Famagusta, Executive Board of EDEK party, Member of Parliament Committee for Education: Giorgos Varnava, Εκπαιδευτική μεταρρύθμιση [Educational reform], *Σημερινή,* 06 Φεβρουαρίου 2005 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 September 2005]; written by Parliament Member of Nicosia, Member of DIKO party, Member of Parliament Committee for Education: Andreas Papadopoulou, Διαμορφωτική Εκπαιδευτική Μεταρρύθμιση [Transformative educational reform], *Σημερινή,* 13 Φεβρουαρίου 2005 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 February 2005]; written by columnist: Sotiris Iakovides, Αντιστάσεις: Οι μεγάλες ψυχές και οι μεγάλες ελληνικές λέξεις [Resistances: Great souls and great Greek words], *Σημερινή,* 02 Φεβρουαρίου 2005 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 February 2005]; written by Member of DIKO party in Limassol: A. Kyriakidou, Ναι, στον ελληνοκεντρικό χαρακτήρα της κυπριακής παιδείας [Yes to the Hellenocentric character of Cypriot education], *Σημερινή,* 06 Φεβρουαρίου 2005 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 February 2005]; written by Parliament Member of ΑΚΕΛ party, Member of Parliament Committee for Education: Takis Hadjigeorghiou, $E = MC^2$ ή η

The University of Cyprus Senate confirmed the need for methodical implementation of the proposals and the President of the Republic wholeheartedly congratulated the Committee:

> Education has no room for political expediency or party confrontation. If in any other domain of public life disagreement is inevitable, consensus and agreement is the common goal in education. The success of this dialogue lies in a collective effort and in overcoming prejudice and interests so that a common strategy is in place for the present and the future of the local education.[11]

The then President of the House of Representatives Dimitris Christofias (then Secretary General of AKEL) welcomed the vision of a 'democratic education for all' in the 'complex, multicultural world we live in' and promised that the House would contribute to the effort in a constructive manner.[12] A second line of response avoided discussion on ideological issues so as not to sidetrack the realisation of the reform, but instead, offered refined critique and review of particular aspects. A third line of argument heavily criticised the ideological and theoretical standpoints of the manifesto for attacking Greek/Hellenic-Orthodox ideals. In the words of a philologist: 'a national heritage of three thousand years is questioned by pseudo-arguments for intercultural and multicultural ideology'.[13] The Holy Synod of the Autocephalous Greek-Orthodox Church of Cyprus regretted that it had not been consulted in spite of the Church's historic role.[14] The Open University[15] dismissed the proposal as a-theoretical piece of work riddled with contradictions aimed to de-Hellenise Cyprus. The former Minister of Education and Culture of the former right wing government Ouranios Ioannides (1999-2002) declared that:

> We have a dream: that our children will grow up to be proper Greeks who will live and receive distinctions in European Cyprus (of secured human rights and basic freedoms), in the whole of Europe, but also in the ecumenical motherland earth; and not European youth without identity, no

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σημασία μιας ανακάλυψης [E = MC² or the importance of discovery], *Σημερινή,* 06 Φεβρουαρίου 2005 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 February 2005]; written by President of the Parliament Committee for Education, Parliament Member of DISIS party: Nikos Tornarides, Ούτε κόκκινες ούτε γαλάζιες πολιτικές για την παιδεία - χαιρετισμός στην εκδήλωση για την έναρξη διαλόγου για την Εκπαιδευτική Μεταρρύθμιση, στο Συνεδριακό [Neither red, not blue policies for education – Introductory speech at the event for commencement of dialogue for the Educational Reform at Conference Centre], *Σημερινή,* 06 Φεβρουαρίου 2005 [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [22 September 2005]; written by journalist presenting reactions from the Church: Kostas Perikleous, Βέτο από την Εκκλησία: Αντιδράσεις για την Εκπαιδευτική Μεταρρύθμιση [Veto from the Church: Reactions against the Educational Reform], *Σημερινή*, 12 Αυγούστου 2005. [Available at: http://www.simerini.com.cy] [02 December 2005].

11 Speech of the President of the Republic of Cyprus, Tassos Papadopoulos cited in *Cyprus Today*, XLII, 1 (2005): 24.

12 Speech of the President of the House of Representatives and General Secretary of AKEL (Communist party), Dimitris Christofias cited in *Cyprus Today,*(note 8): 24-25.

13 Antonis Hadjikonstantas, Επιβάλλεται συνολική και σφαιρική εκπαιδευτική μεταρρύθμιση.[A total and overall educational reform is vital], *Machi,* December 2, 2004, 5. (Hadjikonstantas is a secondary school teacher-philologist who teaches history).

14 Kostas Perikleous, (note 10)

15 With Resolution No.57.357 of February 13th 2003, the Council of Ministers of the Republic of Cyprus appointed the existing Interim Governing Board of the Open University of Cyprus which is composed of the following academics: Prof. Panos Razis, President; Prof. Georgios Filokyprou, Vice-President; Prof. Andreas G. Orphanides, Member; Prof. Christodoulos Yiallouridis, Member ; Prof. Antonis Tsakmakis, Member ; Prof. Fotios Gravanis, Member; Prof. Michalakis Pilavakis, Member. They expressed their opposition in a press release entitled: *Σχόλια και παρατηρήσεις για την Έκθεση της Επιτροπής Εκπαιδευτικής Μεταρρύθμισης που επιγράφεται 'δημοκρατική και ανθρώπινη παιδεία στην ευρωκυπριακή πολιτεία: Προοπτικές ανασυγκρότησης και εκσυγχρονισμού' [Comments and observations on the Report of the Committee for Educational Reform: Future steps for restructuring and modernisation]*, 25 Νοεμβρίου 2004. [Available at http://www.humanrights-edu-cy.org/] [20 March 2005]

> personality and without a civilization of their own …. We need to know whether instead of nurturing youth who could demand their freedom, we should prepare the young ones to accept slavery and compromise with occupation.[16]

For those who opposed the Manifesto's ideological orientation, no educational reform should be proposed especially regarding history teaching, without taking into consideration the current stalemate of division, and not before a rightful solution for all Cypriots is found, one that would guarantee restoration of human rights, safety issues, withdrawal of Turkish troops and settlers.

Such reactions and the reluctance of the then Minister of Education and Culture, who belonged to the party of the centre, (DIKO), to proceed with radical changes on this issue meant that other issues of educational reform were prioritised and the reform of history education was put aside. However, the issue of history reform re-emerged in late 2006 and early 2007 when the new history textbook for the sixth Grade of the Elementary School written in Greece by the team of Professor of History Didactics at the University of Thessaloniki, Maria Repousi ignited a new round of heated public debate in Greece that was belatedly imported in Cyprus too. The book, despite its few inaccuracies, comprised a paradigmatic shift in terms of the pedagogy of history teaching with a critic of the ethnocentric narrative with the main aim of the promotion of critical thinking and historical skills and an emphasis on the use of sources. The officials of the Ministry of Education and Culture of the Republic of Cyprus became defensive, despite the initial dissemination of the book in the beginning of the academic year, as the attacks against the book increased by the Church and nationalistic circles and asked the Greek government to make a change the terminology used in the book.

The objections voiced by centre and right-wing Greek Cypriot politicians related to the failure of the writer to use the officially-sanctioned Cyprus problem terminology. They objected to references to the 'northern part' of the island, which should have been called 'occupied area', and to 'the Turkish Cypriot state', as well as to the absence of any mention of the missing. They also claimed there was not enough written about the refugees and no mention of the role played by EOKA B in the coup. Another point of tension was a map of Cyprus, which showed half of the island -the area occupied by the Turkish army- in a different colour from the other half; this was interpreted as an attempt to imply that in Cyprus there were two 'states'.

The methodological virtues of the book largely went unnoticed in the public debate. It was at this juncture that the unfortunate event of the death of the Greek Cypriot Minister of Education and Culture, Pefkios Georgiades, in January 2007 that gave an AKEL Minister (Neoklis Silikiotis) for the first time in history the chance to serve as a substitute Minister of Education for a few weeks pending the appointment of a new Minsiter of Education coming from DIKO. The substitute Minister argued that the example of the Repousi book controversy showed that Cypriots needed to write their own history textbook for Cypriot history so that they should not depend on Greek books and their mistakes. In February 2007 he established the *Scientific Committee for History* of both left and right wing Cypriot academic historians, a Doctor of history didactics and two Ministry of Education Inspectors with the mandate to study the textbooks of Cypriot history currently in use and make suggestions for the writing of new Cyprus history textbooks from the elementary level to the Lyceum. Despite the fact that tensions and

[16] Ouranios Ioannides, "Interview on Educational Reform," *Antilogos* Newspaper, 30 October 2004, Section: Main articles.

arguments were reportedly taking place in this committee a report that was leaked in the newspaper *Alithia* in August 2008[17] suggested that the textbooks committee produced important suggestions for substantial changes in the history textbooks. The main suggestions concerned the introduction of multiperspectivity; examination of sources; the interdisciplinary approach in history teaching; the addition of material to include events up to 2004 when Cyprus joined the EU. Furthermore, it pointed out the need to enhance the study of minorities in Cyprus and also to study the history of the Turkish Cypriot community and its relations with the Greek Cypriot community in more detail. It also stated that the new books should avoid biased analyses, be objective and avoid prejudiced language. However, the issue of who, when and how would write the new history textbooks would be decided later and is not discussed in the report. This committee completed its task and was dissolved by the current Minister of Education and Culture Andreas Demetriou in December 2008.

The effort the reform for history education took a renewed impetus with the election of Dimitris Christofias as the President of the Republic of Cyprus in the February 2008 elections. In the pre-election period he made no secret that if elected his government would move forward with the educational reform as proposed in the manifesto of the 7 academics back in 2004, including most of the suggestions in history teaching reform. In one of his last statements in the media before the elections he said that he would certainly change the history textbooks once elected to make them more objective. Since the summer of 2006, the Greek Cypriot AKEL party that Dimitris Christofias belongs to, and the Turkish Cypriot CTP had agreed that the way history was presented and taught in schools both north and south of the Green Line was not helpful in creating an understanding of the 'other side' and encouraging the peaceful co-existence of Greek and Turkish Cypriots.

The newly appointed Minister of Education and Culture, a Professor of Developmental Psychology at the University of Cyprus and then Rector of the temporary administration of the newly founded Technical University of Cyprus (TEPAK), made statements towards this direction although he was careful to present the history reform as just a minor part of the larger picture of the educational reform of all subjects taught in public schools. A central committee for the reform of all curricula was established in June 2008 comprising mainly Cypriot academics, representatives from teacher trade unions and some leading academics from Greece. In fact the president of this committee and director of the whole educational reform is a Greek Professor of Education known for his work on Inter-cultural and Anti-Racist education Giorgos Tsiakalos. The decision of Andreas Demetriou to involve Greek academics aimed both at locating Greek speaking professors in the fields needed that were not found in Cyprus but also to ease the fears of the nationalist circles that the educational reform aimed at the '*dehellenisation*' of the Greek Cypriot education.

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[17] Katerina Eliadi, Έτσι θα γραφεί η νέα Ιστορία [This is how the new History will be written], *Αλήθεια*, 11 Αυγούστου 2008. [Available at: http://alithia.com.cy/alithia_v2/front-end/main.php?action=nptext&page=nptext&design=default&nptext_id=19286 [20 December 2009].

More importantly, the major aim of the academic year 2008-2009 was declared to be "cultivation of a culture of peaceful coexistence, mutual respect and co-operation between Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots with the aim of overcoming occupation and leading to reunification of our country and people". This aim was clearly supported by the leadership of both left wing AKEL and in the beginning by right wing DISY although dissenters from DISY also soon joined representatives of centrist DIKO and socialist EDEK in an anti-history reform rhetoric creating a climate in the beginning of the academic year 2008-2009 where AKEL seemed to be marginalised in its educational policies despite the fact that DIKO and EDEK are actually until today taking part in the government led by AKEL.

As the plans to move on with the history reform started materialising the nationalist section and education trade unionists of DISY, leading figures in DIKO and EDEK and the Church soon started complaining that the Ministry had plans to distort history by downgrading the EOKA struggle, *dehellenising* the island or compromising the fighting spirit against Turkish occupation. They also complained that AKEL had a hidden agenda to write a left wing version of history and thus asked to be consulted in the appointment of the members of the special committee that would reform the history curriculum. The Archbishop even asked to have a representative in the committee that would be established to write the new history curriculum but the Minister refused to satisfy his wish. With the help of conservative and nationalist newspapers this camp also initiated an orchestrated campaign of pre-emptive attacks and smearing of people and organisations who according to their view might be given, in the future, a role in the writing of the new history curriculum. It seems that the issue of history reform and the Minister were used as a scapegoat to launch an attack against president Christofias himself and his policies, since they disagree with his current efforts to negotiate with the Turkish Cypriot leader Mehmet Ali Talat a bi-zonal, bi-communal federation with political equality between the two communities.

The result of these pressures was that the appointments of a *Special Committee for the Reform of the History Curriculum* in February 2009, comprised by 5 academic historians (3 Greeks and 2 Greek Cypriots) as the result of consensus among the parties of DISY, DIKO, EDEK and AKEL. The absence of a specialist in history teaching was a significant gap in these appointments that is expected to weaken the pedagogical value of the proposals of this committee. The president of the committee is the Greek Professor Ioannis Chasiotis a former colleague of the Minister in the University of Thessaloniki, personally selected by the minister, but the rest are nominations by different parties. This committee will act jointly with a group of 21 educators (from both elementary and secondary) to produce during the summer of 2009 the new history curriculum. The 21 educators are essentially all the educators who actually volunteered to take part in the educators committee for revision of the history curriculum after a call by the Ministry to educators that teach history and are qualified to join the relevant committee.

1.1.5 Recent Political Developments in the Turkish Cypriot community and reactions in the Media

Since March 2004 when Mehmet Ali Talat's *Republican Turkish Party* (CTP) came to power with a mandate to solve the Cyprus issue and bring the Turkish Cypriot community into the

European Union (EU), the aim has been to create a history syllabus that would give 'an objective view of Cypriot history'. Such were the claims advanced by educational officials like Dr Hasan Alicik who stated that 'Even before we came to power there were calls for a new Cyprus history book coming from all quarters of society'[18] . Both pedagogical arguments for the modernisation of history teaching and ideological arguments for the avoidance of hatred and chauvinism towards Greek Cypriots and also the avoidance of prejudiced attitudes against the EU where employed in this effort. Identity politics where also part of the agenda of this effort, as admitted by Alicik himself – the effort aimed at promoting a more inclusive identity premised on tolerance and multi-perspectivity.

Three new books covering the history of Cyprus from the arrival of its first inhabitants to the present were published for the secondary school[19]. In addition, textbooks were produced for the elementary schools and the lyceum. The new text books for secondary education were reviewed by POST-Research Institute and Papadakis and were praised as a paradigmatic shift that changed both the narrative structure and moral stance of the main actors, the identity politics towards a more Cypriocentric view as well as the pedagogic approach with an emphasis on colourful illustrations, photographs, maps and cartoons that are extensively used to portray the thoughts and opinions of people. A more detailed comparison of the textbooks in both communities is provided in section 5.2.1.

Still, according to an evaluation by Papadakis[20] the books remain to a significant extent ethnocentric, though now from a Turkish Cypriot rather than Turkish perspective, due to more coverage of issues like social life, monuments and culture, press and political personalities provided for the Turkish Cypriot community.

The effort to reform history teaching in the Turkish Cypriot community attracted the, media's interest as expected. The pro-solution, mainly leftist, media supported this change, but right wing parties, journalists and historians reacted strongly against it. Former President Rauf Denktaş and heavily criticized the content and approach of the textbooks and pointed out the danger of the erosion of Turkish national identity and the links with motherland Turkey. The authors of the textbooks were attacked by the nationalist media and were labelled as traitors, particularly by nationalist newspapers.

More recently, the public debate on the textbooks and history education reappeared because of the general elections in April 19, 2009. The new textbooks have been part of the election campaign by the right wing conservative parties and groups. The right-wing National Unity Party (UBP) announced that if they are re-elected, they would re-write the Turkish Cypriot history books. It was argued that "There are tangible mistakes in the books. If we take power, our experts will review the history syllabus and make the appropriate corrections". They added: "We'll do exactly the same as the CTP did when they came to power". The Democratic Party

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[18] Simon Bahceli, Rewriting the history books in the north, *Cyprus Mai,* 10 October 2009. [Available at http://www.cyprus-mail.com/cyprus/rewriting-history-books-north] [11 November 2004].

[19] Available at http://www.mebnet.net/Kitaplar/index.htm (assessed December, 19, 2007)

[20] Yiannis Papadakis, *History Education in Divided Cyprus: A Comparison of Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot Schoolbooks on the "History of Cyprus"*, Nicosia: PRIO, 2008. [Available at http://www.hisdialresearch.org/Articles/Report-History%20Education%20PRIO%20(2).pdf] [15 December 2009].

also criticised the new textbooks by saying that the new textbooks do not reflect the history of Turkish Cypriots since the history textbook was turned into a textbook on culture.

Another development is the recent campaign led by a group called the National Struggle Council's Historical Technical Committee who had meetings with all political parties to convince them to review the updated history syllabus accusing the history textbooks attempted to present Greek and Turkish Cypriots as if they were "as similar as eggs in a basket; but the truth is that we are different in every way". It was also mentioned that "The aim of the books is to divert people and turn them into Cypriots who forget their Turkishness. They are brainwashing our children".[21]

However, from the other end of the ideological spectrum the new textbooks were supported by Şener Elcil, the Secretary General of the powerful left-leaning Turkish Cypriot Teacher's Union (KTÖS). Elcil said that the ones who based their politics for years on the blood and tears of this society are trying to come forward with their chauvinistic explanations on history textbooks and history education. "The racist understanding indoctrinated young brains with hatred and prejudices rose from the grave. He pronounced that "it is unacceptable to support going backward and teaching history with blood, tears, enmity, chauvinism and biases. It should be known that we will stand up harshly against the ones trying to prevent change."[22]

Despite these reactions the National Unity Party (UBP) only six months after it came to power materialised their promise and wrote three new textbooks that according to initial evaluations follow a nationalist paradigm.[23] In particular Hasan Alicik, now ousted from his position in the Turkish Cypriot educational authorities, after CTP lost the April 2008 election, criticised the three new textbooks for high school, for overemphasising conflict, and nationalist discourse. In the book for the tenth grade the words 'conflict', 'martyrs', 'Rauf Denktash' are mentioned many times. He also writes that there were facts omitted that were in the previous books like the fact that Cyprus emerged from the sea, the killings of journalists Ayhan Hikmet and Muzaffer Gurkan, reduction of social and cultural history. The major handicap he identifies in the books concerns the confusion of identity. The term 'Kıbrıslı Türk' (Turkish Cypriot) is sometimes used and at other times the term 'Kıbrıs Türkü' (Turk of Cyprus) is used.

1.1.6 The third space of Inter-communal Contact and Co-operation and International co-operation in history teaching

Since the opening of the checkpoints on 23 April 2003 a "third space" of inter-communal contact and co-operation started evolving at the civil society level in different fields of interest (trade, education, environment etc.). In the field of education a common platform of Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot educators was created that usually organises, on a voluntary basis, bi-communal events, and exchange visits of students and staff to schools of the other community.

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[21] Simon Bahceli, "Threat to revert to old version of Turkish Cypriot history books", *Cyprus Mail*, 12.March 2009. [Available at: http://www.cyprus-mail.com/cyprus/threat-revert-old-version-turkish-cypriot-history-books] [May 5, 2009].

[22] "Yeni Beyaz Sayfa Açılmalı" [A new page shall be opened], *Kıbrıs daily,* April 30 2009. [Available at: http://www.kibrisgazetesi.com/index.php/cat/2/news/70719/PageName/Ic_Haberler [May 20, 2009].

[23] Hasan Alicik, "UBP'nin Yeni Tarih Kitapları" [UBP's new history textbooks], *Yenidüzen Gazetesi*, 23 September 2009. [Available at: http://www.yeniduzen.com/detay.asp?a=12422&z=17], [18 May 2009].

Particularly, in the field of history teaching, the up to then limited contacts between academics on this issue, evolved into a grass-roots[24] civil society entity of educators led by the inter-communal non-govermental organisation, Association for Historical Dialogue and Research (AHDR)25. In April 2003, this multi-communal, non-governmental association was founded with a mission to promote productive dialogue and research on issues regarding history and history teaching, to strengthen peace, stability, democracy and critical thinking.[26] The AHDR, whose Board comprises Turkish-Cypriot and Greek-Cypriot researchers, historians and educators teaching at primary, secondary and higher education, recognises the values of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the European Convention on Human Rights, the covenants of Human Rights issued by the United Nations, and the UNESCO recommendations relevant to history teaching. In particular, AHDR aims to: enhance quality in learning and teaching of history, emphasising the advancement of historical thinking; encourage communication and cooperation between individuals and organisations interested in history, history teaching and learning locally and internationally; ensure access and equal learning opportunities to individuals of every ability, ethnic and cultural background; provide a forum for the discussion of matters of common interest for individuals concerned with history and history teaching and learning; and promote understanding, respect and cooperation amongst the ethnic groups of Cyprus.

The Association has set as one of its priorities teacher training on the methodology of history teaching as well as the production of common supplementary teaching material. Many inter-communal educational discussions have been organised in collaboration with civil society and teacher trade unions across the divide in Cyprus, and organisations and institutions abroad. As the local partner of the Council of Europe in Cyprus, AHDR co-organised with teacher trade unions, across the divide, a series of collaborative inter-communal seminars and workshops with the Council of Europe – the first one held in June 2004 entitled 'The Council of Europe and History Education' – on the social and cultural history of Cyprus with trainers from various countries of Europe and across the divide in Cyprus. Up to now six seminars[27] were organised in the UN Buffer zone at Ledra Palace hostel, that have set the pace for further cooperation between history teachers across the divide at a local, European and international level.[28] In the last 6 years

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[24] The term 'grassroots' here implies that the creation of the civil society organisation and the group supporting it were spontaneous (and not orchestrated by traditional power structures), its first steps were made at the local level, with many volunteers giving their time to support the initiative.

[25] For information on the Association for Historical Dialogue and Research see: website of the AHDR at http://www.hisdialresearch.org/

[26] The birth of the Association, on 21 April 2003, almost coincided with a historic change that took place on the island when on 23 April 2003, travel restrictions between the two sides of the Green Line in Cyprus were unexpectedly eased and several thousand Greek-Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots had their first chance since 1974 to cross the divide.

[27] Council of Europe education, http://www.coe.int/t/dg4/education/historyteaching/Cooperation/Cyprus/CyprusIntro_en.asp

[28] See for example: Stavroula Philippou and Chara Makriyianni (Eds.) (2004). *Proceedings of the First Educational Seminar by the Association for Historical Dialogue and Research titled 'What does it mean to think historically? Approaches to teaching and learning history*'. Nicosia: Association for Historical Dialogue and Research; Council of Europe (2005). *Multiperspectivity in Teaching and Learning History; Presentations from Seminars and Workshop Materials*, Nicosia, 24-27 November 2004. Strasbourg: Council of Europe; Council of Europe (2004). *Reports of the activities of the Council of Europe in History Teaching in Cyprus* 2004 DGIV/EDU/HIST (2004) 02. Strasbourg: Council of Europe.

AHDR has not only prepared and successfully executed a score of projects (amongst them the production of common supplementary teaching material), but it also produced long term plans for the development of history education in Cyprus and took steps for a wider civil society capacity building. It has managed to co-ordinate its activities with other NGOs across the divide and co-operate with teacher trade unions forging long lasting partnerships on a hotly debated issue. One recent example of such co-operation was the successful co-organisation with local teacher trade unions of the 16th Annual conference of EUROCLIO (the European Association of History Educators) in April 2009. In this conference organized in the UN Buffer zone, 150 History teachers, professors and others from more than thirty countries, and from as far apart as Iceland, and the Scandinavian countries, the USA and Eastern Europe, met with teachers and others from both sides of the divide in an important and ground breaking conference which was brought together by AHDR, EUROCLIO and seven teacher trade unions and their organizations. Participants listened to and discussed a variety of perspectives on recent Cypriot histories, visited schools on both sides of the divide and talked about the risk of purely ethnocentric viewpoints.

The activities of AHDR are generally well received by the authorities across the divide as an effort that started from the non-governmental sphere, thus overcame issues of recognition; and provided great level of expertise. Up to this date, the AHDR has rarely been attacked by nationalist newspapers, as it keeps a low media profile issuing only press announcements for its activities. Most importantly, AHDR board members come from different political orientations and thus are not linked to any particular party. AHDR has recently submitted a proposal[29] for the educational reform of history teaching across the divide to both educational authorities and members of AHDR are an active component of the efforts for history reform in both educational systems. In this proposal the AHDR states that "in order to promote students' historical thinking and understanding, a complete reform on history education in Cyprus, informed by educational research, is needed. This reform should be based on the understanding that history education is primarily about developing concepts and dispositions that are essential part of the discipline of history. The need for new curricula and textbooks is urgent. Initial and in-service teacher training in history education and the support of their everyday practice is also an essential element towards reform."[30]

Finally, AHDR is also the local partner of the *Center for Democracy and Reconciliation in Southeast Europe* (CDRSEE) for the implementation of the Joint History Project[31] phase on the island. Aiming amongst other to: "utilise participative methodologies of history education in order to encourage, support and bring about democratic change in Southeast Europe by working through democratic values and fostering the emergence of citizens who are empowered to defend and promote these", the Joint History Project phase in Cyprus entails the translation of the Alternative History Materials[32] on into Turkish, workshops and its dissemination. The media

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[29] The proposal can be found in English, Turkish and Greek on the webpage of AHDR, http://www.hisdialresearch.org/

[30] Ibid.

[31] More information available at the CDRSEE website: http://www.cdsee.org/jhp/gr_tr_edition.html

[32] The Alternative History Materials comprise four multi-perspective history workbooks: Workbook 1: The Ottoman Empire, Workbook 2: Nations and States in Southeast Europe, Workbook 3: The Balkan Wars, Workbook 4: The Second World War available in seven languages and downloadable for free at Center for Democracy and Reconciliation in Southeast Europe, http://www.cdsee.org/jhp/download_eng.html

publicity that the project has attracted in the Greek-Cypriot press has been rather negative with newspapers like nationalist *Simerini* accusing CDRSEE for attempting to distort Cyprus' history and imposing "foreign" identities and suspicious allegiances. In the Turkish Cypriot press the publicity was more positive. The reactions, however, of those participating in the workshops organised jointly by the CDRSEE and the AHDR have been very positive as educators and historians were given the opportunity to discuss the use of such alternative materials in Turkish Cypriot and Greek Cypriot classrooms, exchange ideas and share teaching proposals based on cutting-edge methodologies.

Moreover, in their third report on Cyprus the European Commission against Racism and Intolerance cites the first publication of the AHDR and strongly recommends that such efforts promoting joint activities between educators and also school communities across the divide should be intensified.[33]

The latest publication of the AHDR is a series of booklets titled 'Nicosia Is Calling'. This set of supplementary educational material for youth, educators and parents draws attention to certain restored historical and cultural sites of the walled city (Arabahmet and Chrysaliniotissa Neighbourhoods, Kyrenia and Paphos Gate of the divided city of Nicosia), equipping explorers with resources needed to conceptualise Nicosia as a place of unity and cooperation. The authors, members of the AHDR, have taken a hands-on approach to history in these booklets, which are available in Greek, Turkish and English. Written in a question-and-answer format, interspersed with old photographs and interesting facts about the fortified walls of the city, they are a fresh and different way of coming face-to-face with history. The result is a very active experience for students, teachers and history fans, who can now go on a tour of the beautiful sandstone wall using the booklets as a guide. Activities include comparing photographs taken at different times of the gates' history and spotting the differences; answering questions about different features of the walls; and actually touching the walls and noting down the tactile sensations. There are also word puzzles based on the theme of famous buildings and landmarks. Students and history fans use all their senses to soak in the atmosphere and take in the feeling of what it must have been like when the gates were used by residents, visitors and merchants of the city during medieval times.

1.2 History as a science in universities and research institutes

In the Greek Cypriot community there are six Universities but only the University of Cyprus founded in 1989 offers a degree in History. In particular, the Department of History and Archaeology offers a joint degree in History and Archaeology and provides rigorous academic preparation in the two disciplines (the history of Greece and Cyprus from ancient to modern predominates). Its degree allows graduates to seek employment in a large number of sectors, bodies and institutions, such as secondary education, the archaeological and diplomatic service, research centres, archives, cultural foundations, museums, galleries.[34]

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[33] European Commission against Racism and Intolerance, *Third report on Cyprus CRI(2006)17*. [Available at Council of Europe, http://www.coe.int/T/e/human_rights/ecri/4-Publications].

[34] Department of Archaeology and History, University of Cyprus official website (available at: http://www.ucy.ac.cy/isa/index.html.

In the Turkish Cypriot community, there are also six universities[35]. Among them only three universities, namely Eastern Mediterranean University, Near East University, and Lefke European University have history departments. Eastern Mediterranean University's department of history offers a four-year undergraduate program and provides comprehensive education in Turkish and European history. The curriculum has a major focus on the Ottoman history, palaeography and the methodology of history courses. There are also courses on different periods of the world and European history as well as the history of Cyprus and Eastern Mediterranean. The students of the department are not offered any pedagogical courses to become teachers as it is the case in the Greek Cypriot community. Yet they are qualified to take graduate courses at any Faculty of Education for three semesters, without thesis, and have a master's degree in Pedagogy to become teachers. Similarly, they can take three semesters pedagogy program from the Teacher's Academy to be qualified to teach. It needs to be noted that they are allowed to teach only in lower and upper secondary schools as primary schools teachers are educated solely in the Teacher's Academy.

History at Lefke European University was established in 1998 and it is the oldest history department in the north. The present curriculum was harmonized and adjusted to the European Union's Erasmus program and adopted since the 2006-2007 academic year. The curriculum gives weight to Turkish history, European history, history of the Turkish Republic and Ottoman Palaeography. Students are also offered must courses on the Cyprus history, methodology of history, history of the Middle East; and elective courses on the archive sources during the Ottoman Cyprus era, history of press, history of Mediterranean civilizations, history of Turkish education, basic Greek, and international politics and Cyprus. The language of education is Turkish but the new program enables students to take elective foreign language courses and improve their language skills. As in the Eastern Mediterranean University's department of history, students of Lefke are not given any pedagogy course, which is required to become a teacher. On the other hand, they have the same opportunity to get a master's degree in Pedagogy for being eligible to teach.

2. The didactics of history as a scientific discipline

2.1 Academic position between pedagogy and historical science

The Didactics of History in the Greek Cypriot community is a field that attracted the attention of a few educators with a special interest in this field who produced a few publications (books and articles) in the past and a field of study that has only recently started being taught in the pedagogical faculties of the University of Cyprus, the European University and the University of Nicosia. It is worth noting that in the University of Cyprus the course was until 2008 not taught as an autonomous subject but as a course of didactics in the social studies. From this year the course *history didactics* has been introduced but it is taught by a historian and not a

[35] The universities in the Turkish Cypriot community are considered by the Republic of Cyprus as illegal and are not part of the Bologna Process, see http://www.mfa.gov.cy/mfa/mfa2006.nsf/All/632D3EF2D186156CC22571BC0033E0A0?OpenDocument&highlight=illegal%20university

specialist of history teaching which should be considered a hindrance for the development of this area of research in the University of Cyprus.
In the Turkish Cypriot community, the Near East University has the only history teaching department among the three universities offering historical studies in the north. It is also the newest department, started to enrole students in fall 2006. The studies take five years and students take various educational pedagogy courses, including planning and evaluation in education, special education techniques, teaching technologies and developing material. The first seven semesters of the undergraduate program focus on the social, economical, political and cultural aspects of the history of Eastern Mediterranean. Nevertheless, the main axis of the program is the Ottoman and Turkish history. Comparative and interdisciplinary approaches to the histories of Asia and Europe deem to enrich the undergraduate program. Next to carrying out the program, the aim is mentioned to raise also members, who will protect the constitutional order, preserve national unity and solidarity in the light of Kemalist thinking and the principles and revolutions of Atatürk; undertaking scientific research, learning and teaching around national culture and values.[36] Though there are no graduates from the department yet, the potential graduates can be history teachers both in public and private schools.

Although the academic position of history didactics is struggling for recognition in the academic sphere[37], it has a much stronger, longer and lively presence in the NGO sector as discussed earlier.

2.2 History of the didactics of history

2.2.1 History of History Didactics

There is indication that the first pedagogical considerations around history teaching in the Greek Cypriot community emerged with the establishment of the Republic of Cyprus in 1960 as an independent state (with separate educational systems) with the publication of a short 58 page book by Frixos Maratheftis entitled Didactics of History and Geography.[38] The author belonged to the teaching staff of the Pedagogical academy and held an M.A from a University in the UK. In the introductory part of the book the author states:

> One of the main achievements of the glorious struggle of the Greeks of Cyprus against foreign dynasty was the liberation of our education. The education of this place is now in our hands, the hands of the Greek Cypriots, and unhindered we can now offer to the offspring of Cyprus education at level with the one received by the children of motherland Greece and other countries of the civilised world. To achieve the general aims of the high mission of Hellenochristian education, it is necessary to have best quality teaching of each course at all levels of elementary education. Quality teaching implies on one hand a clear statement of the aims of each course in the curriculum, on the other hand knowledge

[36] "Amaçlar ve Hedefler" [Objectives and Goals], *Tarih Öğretmenliği Bölümü* [Website of the Department of History Teaching, Near East University]. [Available at: http://www.neu.edu.tr/?q=node/213] [12 May 2009].
[37] It is always useful to keep in mind that Tertiary Education in Cyprus is essentially an accomplishment of the two last decades across the divide.
[38] Frixos Maratheftis, *Didactics of History and Geography,* (Nicosia: Pedagogical Academy, 1961).

> of this aim by the teacher. The Greek educational authorities of the island have already set down the aims of the courses taught in the elementary school.[39]

The aims presented by Martheftis as the aims of history teaching are to attain knowledge of the past to better handle the future and its problems, to help the pupils become better citizens and Greeks, so as to imitate their great deeds and avoid their mistakes. Also to appreciate the god given gift of freedom so as to be ready to struggle for it if need arises. It also aims at strengthening the language and thinking skills and it finally develops the judgement of the child.
According to Maratheftis the content of history teaching should be the history of Cyprus and Greece. He adds that "foreign history should only be taught to the extend necessary to assist better understanding of the local and national history".[40] He gave great importance to the teaching of Greek History as the history of the nation. "The history of the nation, in the case of Cypriots, Greek history alone, will provide the child with the lessons needed to become a good citizen and a good Greek".[41]
The next relevant publication by a Greek Cypriot comes about 20 years later from Persianis as a six-page article in the Greek Journal *Nea Paideia* that was then a popular outlet for Greek Cypriot educationalists who took part in the more general debate around education. The article is entitled "Objective aims of the teaching of history". Persianis proposes that the teaching of history should have both cognitive and emotional aims, both basic and advanced.
The basic aims according to Persianis seem to be guided by general pedagogical principles and the idea that history teaching should promote a certain morality:

> 1. The Attainment of some basic and important information for the life and historical trajectory of Greeks and other people. This information concern facts, institutions, actions and ideas.
> 2. The attainment of some skills: a) understanding of maps, diagrams and tables, b) extraction of information from them and c) construction of maps, diagrams and tables, d) extraction of historical information from books and other sources (documents, newspapers, minutes of parliament etc.) e) identification of main points, f) distinction between fact and opinion, g) comprehension of the relationship between facts, personalities monuments, etc. h) correlating parallel facts, personalities monuments, etc. k) summarising and announcing a unit, l) writing of a short essay.
> 3. Understanding and learning of certain principles (general ideas, laws)
> 4. Understanding and learning of basic concepts and terms.

He goes on to describe eighteen advanced aims split into two groups: Knowledge and the Emotive (*Θυμικόν*). The first five include a) understanding and interpretation of facts, ideas, actions and institutions, b) identification of values guiding life and decisions and understanding of the ways that these values are materialised (deeds, decisions, way of living, creations), c) Attainment of the ability to understand current reality (situation, problems) by correlating them with past events, d) attainment of inquiring mind (to learn not to accept uncritically information and opinion but to doubt and investigate), e) Initiation to the methods of scientific research (e.g enquiry into the true causes, estimate of the age of churches and icons, etc., hypothesis setting and testing with the help of new evidence).

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[39] Idem, Didactics of History (note 38),15.
[40] Ibid.,15.
[41] Ibid.

The nine emotive advanced aims are: a) Experiencing basic historic facts and epochs, b) Attainment of positive attitude towards cooperation through the realisation of interdependence between individuals and peoples, c) Reconciliation with the idea of change in human affairs and preparation of accepting changes in life (relevant value of things, adjustment to new situations, ways of thinking and acting), d) Moral reflection initiated by historical facts, e) Cultivation of a sense of responsibility towards self, co-citizens, the polity, the homeland and humanity, f) Realisation of the value of history and attainment of historical interest and love for historical inquiry and research, g) Aesthetics, h) Cultivation of respect for historical and archaeological monuments and generally towards the cultural past, k) Admiration for the epic struggle of humanity to survive and progress beyond the point that nature left it.

In about the same time the first publications on the methodology of teaching *per se* start to appear by the pioneer of the field in Cyprus, Antoniades.[42] In his articles in Nea Paideia and his 190-page book Antoniades makes clear and concrete proposals for the teaching of history mainly based on bibliography from the UK and Greece rather than research in Cyprus. In his book he discusses the aims and objectives of history teaching, the organisation of a lesson, proposes teaching activities and a variety of methods. He discusses the use of the textbook and the use of sources, projects, the study of local and oral history, museum education, role playing, the use of songs, cartoons and comics, and the use of various teaching aids like maps, OHP, the video and the blackboard. He finally discusses evaluation of the lesson and homework. In his book Antoniades does not actually propose the ideal aims and objectives of history as done by previous writers. He takes the 1981 curriculum aims and translates them into concrete methodological suggestions. It is worth noting that the aims of history teaching in this curriculum where strongly influenced by the 'new history' teaching movement in the UK with an emphasis in process and enquiry rather than content and memorisation of great men and politicians. These aims are structured under the tripartite scheme of knowledge, skills and attitudes. In the attitudes we read: accepting a variety of opinions, emphasis on democratic processes, love for the country without chauvinism, love for freedom and democratic values, love for national heritage, overcoming of prejudices, based on race, language, religion etc. Still, this new approach was not reflected in the textbooks themselves nor the actual history teaching in the classroom that remained teacher cantered and ethnocentric.

Similarly, the work of Skouros[43] is strongly influenced by the 'new history' and in his two books he dedicates chapters to explore the pedagogical and philosophical background of 'new history' and presents a piece of research on the understanding of substantive concepts by Greek Cypriot

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[42] Λέανδρος Αντωνιάδης, "Μελέτες, Έρευνες μαθητών στο μάθημα της Ιστορίας," *Νέα Παιδεία*, 21, (1982): 175-181 (Λέανδρος Antoniades, "*Studies, Projects of students in the teaching of history*", Nea Paideia, 21 (1982): 175-181); Λέανδρος Αντωνιάδης , *Η Διδακτική της Ιστορίας*. (Λευκωσία: Παιδαγωγικό Ινστιτούτο, 1989) (Antoniades, L. *History Didactics* (Nicosia: Pedagogical Institute, 1989).

[43] Τρύφωνα Σκούρου, *Η Νέα Ιστορία: Σύγχρονη Αντίληψη για τη Διδασκαλία της Ιστορίας με τη Χρήση των Πηγών*. (Λεμεσός: Έκδοση συγγραφέα, 1991) (Tryfonas Skouros, *The New History: New Approaches to the Teaching of History through the Use of Sources* (Limassol: Publication of Author, 1991)); Τρύφωνα Σκούρου Α, *Η Ιστορία και η Διδακτική της*. (Λεμεσός: Έκδοση συγγραφέα, 1997) (Tryfonas Skouros, *History and History Teaching* (Limassol: Publication of Author, 1997)]. Tryfonas Skouros, Η κατάκτηση των αφηγηματικών ιστορικών εννοιών από τους Ελληνοκύπριους μαθητές της έκτης δημοτικού (11-12) (The acquisition of the narrative historical concepts by GreekCypriot pupils of the sixth form of primary school (11-12)), *Παιδαγωγική Επιθεώρηση*, 29 (1999): 147-168.

pupils aged 11-12, which is done for the first time in the Cypriot context. He identifies himself with developments in the UK and particular Thompson's position that the basic thesis of the 'new history' is emphasising process over content, the development of the ability for more inquiry based and in depth study of the sources, the handling of conflicting accounts, the evaluation of sources and the construction of judgements and their support be argument based on the use of sources. In his second and bigger 258 page book he additionally discusses the ideal aims and objectives of education. He cites approvingly the 1996 Greek-centred aims of the curriculum produced under the right wing government of Klerides and he proposes side by side the promotion of critical thinking with the promotion of Greek national identity, 'comprehension of the continuity of the Greek nation" glossing over the tensions between these concepts that for many researchers are incompatible and have been discussed as such in many debates of history textbooks around the world.
As regards the Turkish Cypriot community as far as we are aware of there were no books written locally on the theme of history teaching but only books imported from Turkey.

2.3 State of the discipline (items of research, cognitive interest, methods of research, taxonomy of didactical research)

Research around history teaching is currently unsystematically produced by educators who leave Cyprus for post-graduate studies abroad since the absence of permanent academic specialists on history didactics from the Universities hinders the creation of research groups that would set up a systematic study of history didactics. This research gap aspires to be filled by AHDR that has been attracting researchers interested in the didactics of history across the divide. The research focus of researchers working in AHDR is twofold. One line of research takes a critical stance on the ethnocentric blind-spots of the history curricula across the divide,[44] secondary education[45], in particular in relation to the *European Dimension,*[46] and in museum education[47] as well as explorations of the representations of the past, present and future across the divide with a representative sample from both communities.[48] The latter work is interdisciplinary sitting at the interface of social psychology with collective memory and it discussed the recent developments on history teaching reform in Cyprus and identified the ideological positions in the Turkish Cypriot and Greek Cypriot community that support or oppose such reform. The research explores the quality of intergroup relations between Turkish Cypriots and Greek Cypriots through a big questionnaire survey study with representative sample from both communities (N=1653) . The discourses of intergroup relations involve measures of contact, trust, forgiveness,

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[44] Chara Makriyianni and Charis Psaltis, "History teaching and reconciliation," *Cyprus Review, 19* (1997):43-69 [Available at http://www.hisdialresearch.org/Articles/MAKRIYIANNI_PSALTIS_CYPRUS_REVIEW_JOURNAL.PDF] [20 June 2009].

[45] Marina Hadjiiyanni, *Contesting the past, Constructing the future: A comparative Study of the Cyprus Conflict in Secondary History Education*, Germany: VDM Verlag, 2008.

[46] Stavroula Philippou, "The European Dimension in Education and Pupils' Identity: A Study of the Impact of a Primary School Curricular Intervention in Cyprus" (Unpublished PhD thesis, University of Cambridge, 2004).

[47] Chara Makriyianni, *"History, Museums and National Identity in a Divided Country: Children´s Experience of Museum Education in Cyprus"* (Unpublished PhD thesis, University of Cambridge, 2006).

[48] Makriyianni and Psaltis (note 44).

perspective taking, accepted solutions to the Cyprus problem, identities, adherence to particular representations of the events of 1963-1974 and the nature of the Cyprus problem. The results show that taking a particular position on representations of history is closely related to versions of present intergroup relations and projected solutions to the Cyprus problem as well as support or resistance towards the proposed educational reform of history teaching in both communities.
The second line of research stays closer to the educational practice of history teaching and another investigates methodological issues around history teaching.[49] The final line of research is of a comparative nature with other European countries on issues around history teaching as part of the EUROCLIO annual research comparative studies[50].
A major research project of AHDR currently underway expected to finish in 2010 concerns three research components. The first is a 3-way longitudinal questionnaire survey with representative sample from both communities investigating the quality of inter-communal relations as they relate with representations of the past-present and future of Cyprus. The second concerns the first ever to be made benchmarking study with a representative sample of elementary and high school students who teach history in the public sector. This study will explore the epistemological beliefs of history educators, their teaching practices, their views of the aims of history teaching and the quality of their inter-communal relations with the other community. Finally, a former mixed villages study with representative sample from each former mixed village will explore the representations of past-present of future of the former inhabitants of these villages.

2.4. Acceptance of the didactics of history by the historical science and the history lesson

It could be argued that the importance of the didactics of history for the time being in the Greek Cypriot community is not yet appreciated as in other EU countries. There still seems to be in the Cypriot public a general assumption that history education is only about learning content and promoting social aims without any need of understanding the discipline of history and the ways we learn about the past. The absence in the Greek Cypriot Universities of specialists of history education except in one private University further inhibits the production of original research in history didactics and thus the chance to enrich the public ongoing debate around the ideological orientations of history teaching from the perspective of history didactics. Having said this, the acceptance of history didactics in the history lesson is far greater and this again thanks to the work of AHDR in the last 6 years that managed with the collaboration of the Council of Europe to train more than 500 elementary and high school educators the majority of whom claimed to have incorporated ideas and practices from their attendance in these workshops and seminars.

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[49] Virginia Germanou, "Teaching and Learning History in Cyprus Secondary Educational level: What are students perceptions of History and History Teaching" (Dissertation submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirementsfor the degree of Master of Education (MEd) in the University of Hull. September 2007) (available at http://www.hisdialresearch.org/research/VGERMANOU_SUMMARY_RESULTS.pdf).

[50] Research findings from the 2006 and 2007 Research Questionnaire are available at the Association for Historical Dialogue and Research website: http://www.hisdialresearch.org/research.html

3. Fields of use of the didactics of history

Teaching and learning was traditionally seen in Cyprus, across the divide, as a simple transmission of knowledge from teacher to pupil, usually confined within the four walls of a classroom. Yet, from an interactive point of view teaching and learning is a much more complicated process linking together the teacher, the pupil and the subject matter, and can be described as a triangular relationship based on the 'didactic contract' (Figure 1).[51]

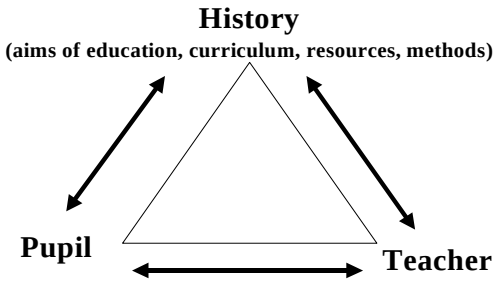

Figure 1: Triangular relationship between History-Pupil-Teacher

In this triangular interaction the aims of a particular curriculum, embedded in textbooks supplied by the government are mediated to the pupil through the teacher by means of particular methods and resources. During this process the teacher imposes constraints on the pupil (through communication, teaching methods, content), but the pupil also sets constraints on teachers (through cognitive and developmental needs). History curriculum, textbooks, resources, methods present constraints for both the teacher and the pupil. Constraints, however, do not *determine* the learning process and outcome, since pupils and teachers have agency.

As agents, teachers and pupils experience relative autonomy yet the triangular relationship between teacher, pupil and subject matter does not function in a social vacuum; other actors and agents play an equally important role in the 'who', 'what' and 'how' of history education in Cyprus. As Figure 2 illustrates, each angle of the basic didactic contract is itself related to other bodies of knowledge and significant others, against a backdrop of shared understandings, practices, language and representations and within a network, or according to Grossen an 'ecology', of interactions at various levels (s. Figure 1):

[51] Teacher-pupil interactions rely upon certain institutions, namely social and school regulations, as well as implicit systems of rules. Different concepts refer to the explicit and implicit rules and everyday routines which organise teacher-pupil interactions. The term 'basic didactic contract' is used by Michele Grossen to mean a system in which the poles 'teacher', 'pupil' and 'subject matter' are interdependent, that is to say each dyad comprising two poles is mediated by a third pole. (Michelle Grossen, "Constructing meanings and context in teacher-pupil interactions" (A keynote Lecture at the 2001 EARLI Conference, Fribourg, Switzerland, 27-31 August 2001).

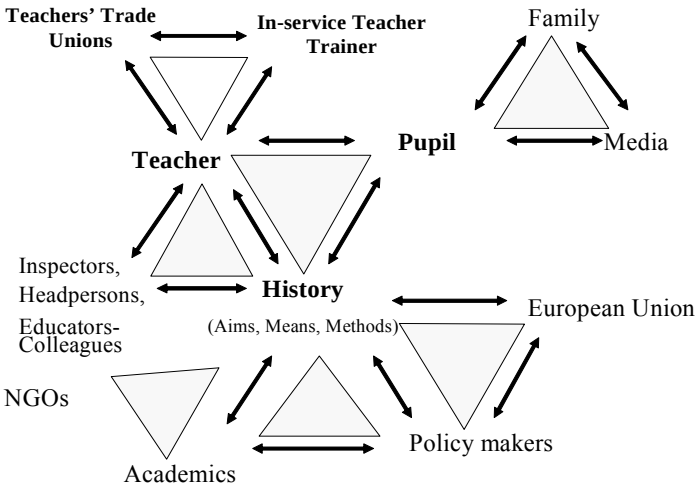

Figure 1: Networking or ecology of triangular relationships

Such triangular relationships can thus be located within different levels of analysis.[52] On the intra-personal level, pupils construct their sense of national identity and historical understanding within certain developmental constraints. Such constructions, however, take place at the inter-personal level, in the symbolic or actual presence of other people from either the in-group or out-group. At a third level of analysis, the inter-group level, social relations between groups are often characterised by asymmetries of status or power that pre-exist any actual encounter. Moreover, in situations of conflict these relationships are characterised by competitiveness, discrimination and negative stereotyping of the other group. Finally, such positions are furnished, become available and legitimised by social representations and ideologies, which are found at a fourth level of analysis.

The significance of an ideological framework and the related discussion of history in relation to the "unresolved Cyprus issue" is crucial for understanding the field of the use of history didactics. In the case of Cyprus, as Hadjipavlou argues, the state school system is an institution that promotes and reproduces official ideology, values and goals in a way that hinders the solution of the Cyprus problem.[53] Ideology is for Althusser what makes people believe that the education system is fair when really it serves the interests of the ruling class or dominant group who control the education system.[54] Schools, Althusser argues, are invested in hiding their true purpose through an obfuscating ideology: an ideology which represents the school as a neutral environment purged of ideology, where teachers, respectful of the 'conscience' and 'freedom' of the children who are entrusted to them by their parents, open up for them the path to the freedom, morality and adult responsibility by their own example, by knowledge, literature and their 'liberating' virtues. So pervasive is this ideology, that those educators who, in hostile,

[52] Willem Doise, *Levels of explanation in social psychology* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1986).

[53] Maria Hadjipavlou, The Cyprus Conflict: Root Causes and Implications for Peace-building, *Journal of Peace Research* (44:3, pp. 349-365, 2007).

[54] Louis .P. Althusser, *Lenin and philosophy and other essays*, Trans Ben Brewster (New York: Monthly Review P, 2001), 105-106.

circumstances 'attempt to turn the few weapons they can find in the history and learning they "teach" against the ideology, the system and the practices in which they are trapped... are a kind of hero'.[55] In this context the training of history teachers in Cyprus acquires special weight.

4. The training of history teachers

4.1 Structure of the education system

4.1.2 Structure of the Greek Cypriot education system

The constitution of 1960 assigned responsibility for education to the Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot communal chambers. After withdrawal of the Turkish Cypriots from all state institutions, of the Republic of Cyprus the Greek Cypriot led government proceeded with the establishment of the 'Ministry of Education' in 1965. Under these educational authorities, the education system evolved its present structure: One-year pre-Primary education has recently become compulsory and it accepts children over the age of 3. Primary education is compulsory and has a duration of 6 years. Secondary General Education offers two three-year cycles of education: *Gymnasio* (lower secondary education) and *Lykeio* (upper secondary education) to pupils between the ages of 12 and 18. Instead of the *Lykeio*, pupils may choose to attend Secondary Technical and Vocational Education which provides them with knowledge and skills which will prepare them to enter the workforce or pursue further studies in their area of interest. In terms of Higher education, as mentioned earlier, there are six Universities in the Greek Cypriot community, three of them public and three private.

4.1.3. Structure of the Turkish Cypriot education system

The education system in the Turkish Cypriot community consists of optional pre-school, five-year primary school and six-year secondary education followed by tertiary education and adult education (lifelong learning)[56]. Currently compulsory education includes primary school and three years of lower secondary school.
Upper secondary school is divided into two streams: academic and vocational – although there is no clear distinction between the two. In principle, students from both streams are eligible to apply to higher education. University education[57] comprises five private Universities and one 'State-Trust University'.

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[55] Louis P. Althusser (note 49).

[56] The World Bank (2006). Sustainability and Sources of Economic Growth in the Northern Part of Cyprus, Volume II: Technical Papers: Poverty Reduction and Economic Management Unit Europe and Central Asia Region.

[57] The universities in the Turkish Cypriot community are considered by the Republic of Cyprus as illegal and are not part of the Bologna Process, see Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Republic of Cyrus, http://www.mfa.gov.cy/mfa/mfa2006.nsf/All/632D3EF2D186156CC22571BC0033E0A0?OpenDocument&highlight=illegal%20university

4.2. Training of history teachers

4.2.1 Teacher training of Creek Cypriot teachers and history teachers

Currently primary school teachers are graduates either of the Pedagogical Academy of Cyprus[58] or of Departments of Education at the University of Cyprus and/or Universities of Greece. Graduates from Universities other than those of Cyprus and Greece have to go through an in-service training at the Pedagogical Institute of Cyprus before applying for appointment in government's schools. Private colleges, registered with the Ministry of Education and Culture, also offer accredited educational degree programmes, both academic and professional, at Bachelor's level.

Although the ethnocentric orientations of the pedagogical academy then remained dominant for several decades, the establishment of a University of Cyprus in 1992 generated a more 'scientific' approach to primary school teachers' training. Still, the ideological orientations of the University were hotly debated, such as in arguments over the official language of the University.[59]

Despite the fact that history is widely discussed as a key subject for teacher education in Cyprus, the University Department of Education intermittently included the course early in its establishment but not for the last 10 years.[60] In contrast, 'Christian' education and Geography education are compulsory courses.[61] In Phtiaka's words, it is

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[58] Up until the independence, primary school teachers in Cyprus were graduates of the 'Morphou Teacher Training College'. For a more in-depth exploration of the educational system during this period, see Michalis Yiangou, Colonial classrooms in Cyprus: Teachers, schools and national identity. Unpublished PhD thesis. Cambridge: University of Cambridge, 2004. Interestingly, in 1935, the British closed the respective Greek and Turkish teacher training institutions to establish in 1937 the 'Morphou Teacher Training college' (Andreas Polydorou, *Η ανάπτυξη της Δημοτικής Εκπαίδευσης στην Κύπρο (1830-1994)* (*The development of Primary Education in Cyprus (1830-1994))*, Nicosia: A.P. Polydorou, 1995). In Morphou, teacher training was carried out jointly in English for Greek-Cypriot and Turkish-Cypriots. Phtiaka argues that this was an attempt to achieve total control of the island's education and culture. (Helen Phtiaka, "Parental education in Cyprus: Past, present and future," *International Studies in Sociology of Education,* 9, 1 (1999): 95-107). I see joint teacher training as having been a unique opportunity for Turkish-Cypriots and Greek-Cypriots to come together under a unified educational policy. Unfortunately, as the Cypriot state declared its independence in 1960, Greek-Cypriot and Turkish-Cypriot primary school teachers separated again. In 1959 the Pedagogical Academy was established for Greek-Cypriot teachers and was replaced by the first state-funded University of Cyprus in 1989.

[59] Debate ensued regarding the official languages of the University. On the one hand were those advocating Greek and Turkish, and on the other those supporting English: 'the use of English as … a measure both to retain international academic connections and to provide a linguistic bridge between Greek and Turkish Cypriots, in preparation for the eventual reunification of the island. ... the use of Greek and Turkish as the two official languages, and the creation of a Turkish Studies Department, would serve the latter goal, while a faculty trained abroad and active in international research would ensure that isolation and stagnation would not occur. … the University would be a more viable option for the economically less privileged classes of Cypriot society, and in any case they thought that no independent country could remain without a university of its own that employed and encouraged the vitality of its own national languages. In the end the supporters of a Greek and Turkish language University of Cyprus won out...An entirely new campus is being constructed in eastern Nicosia, in an area that will be directly accessible to the Turkish Cypriot community even under the present division'. Chris Schabel, History in Cyprus review, University of Cyprus, *Socrates-Erasmus Thematic Network CLIOHnet* [Available at web site: http://www.clioh.net/] [14 March 2003].

[60] Only 'History of Education' is taught. For more details, see online the prospectus of the University of Cyprus [Available at: http://www.ucy.ac.cy/epa/aboutE/aboute.htm l].

[61] In the Curriculum, History along with Geography, Religious Studies and Civic Education go under the umbrella of the Social Science Subjects (In Greek: *Κοινωνικά Θέματα*, '*Kinonika Themata*').

> very worrying that history is not a compulsory course in our current teacher education curriculum. … [we should] put more emphasis on history teaching in our curriculum. In this way, we could hope to reach pupils and improve their understanding of history and their knowledge of traditions without which they cannot comprehend current political and social problems.[62]

In secondary schools, history is taught by philologists.[63] Ever since the British left high school education to the Greek and Turkish communities, Greek-Cypriot secondary teachers were trained mostly in Greece, and this gave philologists prominence and undisputed power within the secondary curriculum: they were the 'guardians of the Greek language and the traditional Hellenic-Byzantine culture on the island'.[64] Philologists were at the height of their prestige when independence was declared: 'the absence of any university on the island rendered them the most learned individuals on the isle'.[65]

Nowadays, philologists are mainly graduates of Greek universities and of the University of Cyprus, which is directly linked to secondary teachers' training via the Faculty of Letters: the Departments of History and Archaeology, Byzantine and Greek Studies, and Classics and Philosophy. The study programme provides academic preparation in their disciplines, working in close relationship with the Education Department; according to the Department's prospectus this offers graduates the necessary knowledge and skills to pursue a career in secondary education, public or private.[66] However, a closer look at each subject department's objectives reveals not only a strong commitment to Greek ideals but also an absence of course on history teaching. The Department of Classics and Philosophy aims at providing its students with 'a sound scholarly background and research skills in the area of classical literature and philosophy', 'excellence in teaching and research in all areas of classical scholarship and philosophy' by continuously communicating with 'international scholarship'. [67] It is also stated that the Department's notable activities 'provide an example of excellent academic achievement in teaching and studying the Classics in the Greek-speaking world.'[68]

The Department of History and Archaeology offers a joint degree in History and Archaeology and provides rigorous academic preparation in the two disciplines (the history of Greece and Cyprus from ancient to modern predominates). Its degree allows graduates to seek employment in a large number of sectors, bodies and institutions, such as secondary education, the

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[62] Helen Phtiaka. Parental education in Cyprus: Past, present and future. *International Studies in Sociology of Education*, 1999, 95-107.

[63] According to the Oxford Dictionary, 2000, a *philologist* is the person who studies language especially in its historical and comparative aspects. In Greek-Cypriot secondary education, philologists teach: Greek Language, Expression/Essay Writing, Latin, Ancient Greek, Journalism, Sociology, Civic Education.

[64] Rebecca Bryant, *Imagining the modern: The cultures of nationalism in Cyprus*, (London: I. B. Tauris, 2004); Yiannis Papadakis, Greek Cypriot narratives of history and collective identity: Nationalism as a contested process. *American Ethnologist*, 1998, 25, 149-165. Kyriacos C. Markides, *The rise and fall of the Cyprus Republic* (Yale: Yale University Press, 1977), 76-121. Note that secondary education retained a highly hellenocentric orientation, even during British colonial era, by resisting British attempts to control the curriculum.

[65] Kyriakos Markides, (note 64).

[66] Department of the Faculty of Letters, University of Cyprus website: http://www.ucy.ac.cy/goto/letters/en-US/HOME.aspx).

[67] Department of Classics and Philosophy, University of Cyprus official website (http://www.ucy.ac.cy/goto/claphi/en-US/HOME.aspx).

[68] Department of Classics and Philosophy, (note 62).

archaeological and diplomatic service, research centres, archives, cultural foundations, museums, galleries.[69] The Department of Byzantine and Greek Studies has for its objectives:

> The study of Greek language and literature from the early meta-Christian years till today, in direct interrelation however with the earlier historical periods (from the archaic to the Hellenistic period); Examination of Greek literary production in the European but also in world content; Research into Greek language and literature in Cyprus.[70]

According to Chris Schabel, 'the entire School of Letters' follows 'older Greek university models' with emphasis 'on all things Greek or connected with Hellenism'.[71] Even this brief representation of the basic education of future teachers at the University of Cyprus reveals its fundamentally mono-cultural, helleno-centric character.

The government has introduced pre-service training for secondary teachers who have to attend the Pedagogical Institute for a year before appointment. Once appointed, teachers are on probation for two years [72] and are freed from teaching two days a week during their first year for compulsory in-service training which is required to gain permanent status. [73] This training is provided by qualified local staff (teachers with a specialization, holders of an MA and/or a PhD) seconded to the Pedagogical Institute. Optional seminars relating to content and approach are held during teachers' free time. Training courses, particularly the optional, are geared to the national curriculum. Each trainer is responsible for their own course, drawing on personalised methodologies. History teaching is not offered as a separate course/subject,[74] whereas courses on the methodology of English, Music and Geography are. Some theoretical and methodological issues regarding the teaching and learning of history are touched upon in short modules like 'Using new technologies in the teaching of philological lessons' and 'Museum Education'. The Pedagogical Institute maintains exemplar lesson plans in written and videotaped form, and has a rich stock of audio-visual material on the History of Cyprus and Greece, archaeological and historical monuments and sites, sound and picture productions, as well as a library with numerous reference books. Publications of Turkish-Cypriot or Turkish authors are not included.

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69 Department of Archaeology and History, University of Cyprus official website (http://www.ucy.ac.cy/goto/hiarch/en-US/HOME.aspx).

70 Department of Byzantine and Greek Studies, University of Cyprus official website (http://www.ucy.ac.cy/goto/byzantine/en-US/Home.aspx).

71 Chris Schabel, *University of Cyprus*, (note 59).

72 A university degree in the subject to be taught makes a teacher eligible for inclusion in the Republic of Cyprus' official registers of candidates for appointment. A teacher's appointment is based on a system where primary priority is determined by the year of submitting the application, on the principle 'first come first served'. Secondary priority, among the applicants of the same year is decided on a system of units that the candidate accumulates according, for example, to the date of graduation and special qualifications. Prior to appointment, a teacher may serve as a substitute and/or maintain temporary status on a contract basis. 'In-Service Training' is currently known in the UK as 'Continuous Professional Development'.

73 This applies to secondary school teachers that have a degree in a subject, but no pedagogical experience, and also to primary school teachers who do not hold a Cyprus or a Greek University Degree, thus needing to become familiar with the theory and practice of the Cyprus curriculum.

74 During 1998-2000, whilst on secondment at the Pedagogical Institute, I designed and taught a new module for primary school teachers entitled: 'Teaching of History and Museum Education'. Ever since, no other similar module was offered.

4.2.3 Training of Turkish Cypriot teachers and history teachers[75]

All teachers teaching in public or in private schools must have a pedagogical certificate issued by a university or a teacher training institution. Primary school teachers are educated at *Ataturk Teacher Training Academy* that is one of the oldest (established in 1937), higher education establishments in Cyprus where primary school teachers are still trained until today. Only *Ataturk Academy,* graduates can be appointed as primary school teachers. Primary school teachers teach history along with all the other courses of the curriculum despite the fact that they are only taught a general course on social sciences but not history teaching during their studies. All secondary school teachers must be graduates of universities and they must have a teaching qualification. Most Turkish universities in Turkey and the ones in the TURKISH CYPRIOT community, offer a pedagogical course which can be taken concurrently with the specialist subjects. The secondary teachers teaching history are all graduates of history departments in either Cyprus or Turkey.

Turkish Cypriot history teachers have generally studied in Turkey and therefore lack sufficient knowledge of Cypriot history themselves. Instead, their education primarily dealt with the history of Turkey as the motherland. History teachers in various workshops and seminars mentioned that they have not been to the historical places mentioned in the textbooks and so they have difficulties explaining these places to their students.

Turkish Cypriot history teachers had received no training in light of the new textbooks produced in 2003, neither was a manual provided. The teachers, who are used to teacher-centred teaching methods, mostly stick to the old ways, which are not in line with the revised textbooks. Therefore, they do not have the technique to be able to use the books effectively. Moreover, the teachers have not been provided supplementary materials, such as maps and videos, in supporting their courses.

5. The history lesson

5.1. The history of the history lesson

The history of the history lesson in Cyprus before 1974 is closely linked with the history of Greek and Turkish nationalism in Cyprus and the use of the educational system to promote the ethnic ideals of *Enosis* and *Taksim*. After 1974 and the division of the island the aims were reoriented in the GREEK CYPRIOT community for liberation by Turkish occupation and reunification of Cyprus and for the Turkish Cypriot community for the continuation of partition and recognition of a separate state, whilst in both cases the close ties with 'motherlands' in the educational system continued unchanged. One could claim based on the description of developments in the last 6 years in both communities that the future of history teaching in Cyprus will, once a solution to the Cyprus issue is found, hopefully disengage history teaching from for the firm grip of ethnocentrism and nationalism in both communities. Steps towards this hopeful future are already seen in the process of reconciliation on the way for a solution in the

[75] More information available at KTOS website: http://www.ktos.org/en/index.php?option=com_content&task=view&id=8&Itemid=12.

recent years in both communities. More detailed accounts of the history of the history lesson have been given elsewhere [76] so we provide more detail in the present status of history teaching in the following sections that concern the curricula and textbooks of history teaching.

5.2. Guidelines, aims, content and curricula for the history lesson

In the Turkish Cypriot community, in the primary school education, history lessons or the historical content is covered in the subjects entitled *Hayat Bilgisi* (Life Science) for Grades 1-3 and *Sosyal Bilgiler* (Social Science) for Grades 4-5. Life science is taught 5 times a week in 40-minute periods. It is one of the main subjects of the primary school curriculum. Social science is taught two times a week in 40-minute periods per week. Throughout the primary school there is no separate history lesson but historical subjects are covered in the Life and Social Sciences classes. (Life science textbooks are published in Turkey, while Social science textbooks are published in Cyprus.

The Turkish Cypriot curricula in the primary school level begins with the environment pupils are familiar with such as the classroom, school, neighbourhood, community, village, town or city based on the 'expanding environment curriculum' or widening horizons' conceptual framework and gradually proceeds to more distant places and subjects.[77] Hayat Bilgisi textbooks 1-3, includes respectively the study of the school: classroom, classmates, family, health and healthy nutrition, human body, Ataturk's childhood and life, trees and animals, our planet, natural disasters, national anniversaries and Turkish national liberation. The aim of the Life Science as noted in the Primary Life Science Syllabus is to teach the "reality". This includes learning the environment we live, citizenship responsibilities and duties, relationship of the individual with the society, economic life and improving life talents. Pupils learn historical content under the part of leadership and republic: where they focus on the leaders of the Turkish Cypriot community, namely Dr. Fazıl Küçük and Mustafa Kemal Atatürk. There is intense reference to Atatürk, since these textbooks are coming from Turkey. Under the republic part, pupils learn "my country TRNC", its administration, president, prime minister, parliament and MPs. There is also reference to EOKA, Akritas Plan, TMT, 1963 population exchange, Peace Operation in 1974 and Bülent Ecevit.[78] It also covers what kind of country 'TRNC should be' and notify/enlighten pupils about the current history of their surroundings.

Life Science is replaced by Social Science as a subject in the last two grades of primary school. Social Science textbooks used during the 4th and 5th grades are a combination of citizenship education, history, geography, economy, sociology, anthropology, psychology, philosophy, political science and law. The aim of the social science units is to develop sufficient and responsible citizens and the books are designed for this purpose. It can be read from the Preface that one of the aims of the Social Science Textbook 4 is character education and topics related with daily life. There is more emphasis on Cyprus: Cypriot culture, Cypriot cuisine, social institutions, economy, democracy and individual rights in Social Science Textbook 5. Regarding

[76] Makriyianni and Psaltis (note 44)

[77] Stavroula Philippou, Dilek Latif, and Hakan Karahasan, "Representations of 'Europe': a comparative analysis of Geography curricula and textbooks used in Cyprus" in *Exploring Europe and Ourselves: Geographies and Identities at Work*, Ed. Stavroula Philippou, (Nicosia: PC's Printways, 2008),18.

[78] Primary Life Science Syllabus, Grades1-3, Cyprus 2006.

the historical content, Social Science Subject Teaching Program, which is the only syllabus for the 4th and 5th grades, mentions the following:

> Students' historical awareness should be improved by using the national and religious days and celebrations, important events, specific days and weeks. Pupils should be taught about important leaders such and Mustafa Kemal Atatürk and Dr. Fazıl Küçük. By using famous proverbs/expressions of Atatürk such as "How happy the one who says I am a Turk", "Türk, be proud, work hard, and trust yourself", "Peace at home, peace in the world", students should be taught about the role Turks placed throughout the history, and Turks service to the humanity in the fields of militarism, administration, law, science and art. Pupils' feelings of respect, love and appreciation for the people who are working for the Turkish nation, TRNC flag, army and homeland should be improved.[79]

Nevertheless there is a shift towards a more Turkish-Cypriot centric approach in the lower secondary school history education, with the new textbooks after 2003 and new teaching methodology. Introduction of the Revision Commission on the new history programme and the new textbooks pronounces this novel approach:

> The Turkish Cypriot community over the passing centuries created its own history. Hence, we should write and teach the history that is being created by the Turkish Cypriot community to new generations. On the other hand, we are faced with a new world order and societal structures based on knowledge in the 21st century. In this new world order, Turkish Cypriot society can exist only with its youth developed by its own society, culture and historical awareness.[80]

For the aim of raising a youth aware of its own cultural identity, who is able to think and criticize, responsible and actively engages in societal life, history lesson programmes and textbooks have been re-prepared. The aims of the textbooks within the general framework of the national education are as follows: 1) Teaching the place of Cyprus history in the world history, and its share in the development of world civilization, 2) Raising awareness on the national, cultural and contemporary identities, 3) Earning love for homeland, nation, human beings and society, 4) Raising thinking, criticizing, responsible and active citizens, 5) On the basis of tolerance to the understanding of identity, improving respect to all kinds of diversity, 6) Comprehending the fundamental values of international peace, human rights and democracy, 7) Teaching the continual historical connection between local, regional and international histories, 8) Making sense of the Cyprus history from the world history perspective, 9) Generating curiosity for learning and analyzing the cultural heritage and its interaction among the societies and cultures, 10) Studying history from diverse perspectives, phenomenon, and convictions, 11) Encouraging critical and analytical learning while transmitting historical events, 12) Demonstrating how individuals influence historical incidents with intellect, courage and vision, 13) Ensuring growth as peaceful citizens but who knows how to protect individual and communal rights.

There is no written syllabus or teaching program for the lower secondary school history education. The Introduction of the Revision Commission is located as foreword in every textbook and invited headmasters and teachers to adopt the indicated aims by placing students at the centre of their teaching. The new history book has been dived into three volumes. The first volume is concerned with general information about the island of Cyprus, the Prehistoric period,

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[79] Social Science Subject Teaching Program, General Aims, Number 9, Primary Social Science Syllabus, Grades 4-5, Cyprus 2006.

[80] "Introduction of the Revision Commission on the new history programme and the new textbooks", cited from POST. *Textual and Visual Analysis,* iii [Available at http://www.postri.org/] [10 December 2009].

Cyprus during the Egyptians rule, Hittites, Greek colonies, Persians, Alexander the Great, Roman Empire, and Cyprus during the Middle Ages (Lusignans and Venetians). The second volume of the book focuses on the Ottoman Period, and the third volume primarily concentrates on the contemporary history of Cyprus.

In terms of the teaching periods, a very limited time is allocated to the teaching of Cyprus history in the curricula. The curriculum time for teaching history was radically reduced to 40 minutes a week. As it was expressed by the teachers they had been forced to complete 4 chapters in a limited time period and most teachers simply highlight the most important parts of the book.[81] Thus, although the books are intended to be taught using a student-centred approach, time constraints mean that such an approach is not actually possible in the classroom. Instead, a teacher centred style of education is still taking place.

During the first two years of upper secondary school, Grades 9-10, students have two separate - History and Cyprus history lessons.[82] In History lesson the topics are history as a science, Turkey and her surroundings in ancient times, first Turkish states, Islamic history and civilization, Turkish world (13th-14th centuries), Turkish history (11th-14th centuries), Ottoman Political History, European History I&II from 1300-1918, Ottoman State Administration, Ottoman Society, Ottoman Economy, and Culture, Art and Education in the Ottomans. The History lessons are taught 2 teaching hours per week.

Cyprus history includes those subjects: Cyprus before the Ottomans, Ottomans in Cyprus, Social-Economical life, Administration of Cyprus is changing (1878-1913), Cyprus between the two Global Wars (1914-45), The Road to Independent Cyprus (1945-1960), the events and developments between the years 1960-2004 in Cyrus. The Cyprus history lesson is taught from the Grades 9-11 for two hours period per week. The History lesson is replaced by History of Turkish Revolution (İnkılap Tarihi) for Grade 11. This lesson covers the 20th century Turkish political history, starting from the Ottoman reforms till the end of Second World War. It also deals with the transition to multi-party system and troubled democracy since 1960. History of Turkish Revolution lesson is taught 2 teaching hours per week, too.

In the last year of the upper secondary school, Grade 12, Contemporary Turkish and World History is the main focus. History is taught 5 hours per week in Grade 12. The essence of the Teaching Program for History and Contemporary Turkish and World History 2008-2009, states among the first aims the teaching of reforms and revolution of Atatürk; Turkish Republic's political, social cultural and economic development and motivate the pupils to sustain the secular, democratic, national and contemporary values, creating a historical consciousness in the sense of past, present and future; by teaching the basic components and processes of Turkish history and culture raising awareness for its protection and development, and comprehending the formation of national identity, components of the identity and the necessity of protecting the national identity.

The aims of the Contemporary Turkish and World History are getting information on the developments in the world and in Turkey from the 19th Century till today; understanding the

[81] Note 80

[82] In Grade 10, students are divided into social science and science classes. The students who are in social science branch have more history lessons than the ones in science.

impact of the political, social, cultural and economic developments in the world over Turkey, and the role of Turkey in the 20th century world; analysing the complex and multi-dimensional globalised world's political, social, cultural and economic events with a diverse point of view, generating the talents to foresee the improving and changing needs of the 21st century; and raising individuals having intellectual and social talents to possess national historical and cultural consciousness and sensitivity, who are capable enough to have interaction with different cultures in the world.

The Greek Cypriot primary school curriculum for the first two years of the primary school includes an interdisciplinary lesson called 'Environmental Study' for two teaching periods per week, in the context of which the pupils are taught some preliminary elements of history teaching. In the 3rd grade of the elementary school, The Greek Cypriot primary school history curriculum states that pupils should study 'historical and cultural sites of the neighbourhood and village/city' they live in. They should be taught Greek mythology, about 'the lives of Cypriots during the Neolithic Age' and 'religion in Cyprus and Greece'; 'life during Bronge Age' and also about the 'Greek Civilisation in Cyprus (Mycenaean)'. In the 4th grade, pupils should study 'an archaeological site of Cyprus', and should be taught about 'the fundamental characteristics that united Greeks (Hellenes) in Cyprus and Greece in the ancient times'. Pupils should also learn about 'the life in Cyprus and Greece in the ancient times'; study 'life in Athens, Sparta, Salamina, Kition' and learn about the 'Blooming of Arts and Letters in Greece and Cyprus during ancient times (Classical years). They should also learn about the 'Struggles of the Greeks (Hellenes) for freedom in Greece and Cyprus'(Persian wars); 'Greeks' (Hellenes') civil wars and their destructive consequences'(Peloponnesian war); 'Unity of the Greeks and its positive results' (Alexander the Great). In the 5th Grade pupils should be taught the Greco-Roman years, Byzantine Era – here they should focus on 'a Byzantine monument in their community' and 'other important Byzantine monuments of Cyprus'; 'the facts that led to the collapse of the Byzantine state and Constantinople's conquest by the Turks' and the 'effect the Byzantine civilisation had on people's lives then and today'. Finally, in the 6th Grade pupils should study 'the Frangokratia (French occupation) in Cyprus and its negative consequences'; 'Turkokratia (Turkish occupation) in Cyprus and Greece and the devotion of the enslaved Hellenism to their national and religious origins'; 'the Hellenic Revolution of 1821'; 'important efforts to organise and expand the new hellenic state' ; 'important stations in the historic trajectory of Greece after the Balkan wars'; 'Modern History of Cyprus and the struggles of the Hellenes of the island for freedom'. The Greek Cypriot primary school history curriculum also notes that time should be devoted, in each grade, for national days. From the 3rd to the 6th grade of elementary school two teaching periods per week are devoted to the history lesson.

A spiral approach to content is followed for the Gymnasium and Lyceum where students are taught the same thematic units, in more depth, more facts and information. In the 1st grade of the Gymnasium the pupils are taught history for 3 teaching periods per week, in the 2nd and 3rd for 2 teaching periods per week. In the 1st grade of the Lyceum they are taught 3 periods per week and then for the last two grades they have the option to take up history as an elective or not. If they take it up as elective in the 2nd grade they have 5,5 periods per week and if not 1,5 periods per

week. If they take it up as elective in the 3rd grade they have 6 periods per week and if not 2 periods per week.

Themes, Grades[83]

Themes	**Primary** *Grades*	**Gymnasium** (Middle School) *Grades*	**Lyceum** *Grades*
Neolithic - Hellenistic Age (of Greece and Cyprus)	3rd 4th	1st	1st
Roman –Byzantine Age (of Greece and Cyprus)	5th	2nd	2nd (all) 2nd (chosen) 2nd (interest)
Contemporary and Modern History (Medieval, Renaissance, French Revolution, Greek Revolution, Balkan Wars, World War I and II, Minor Asia, Establishment of Republic of Cyprus)	6th	3rd	3rd

The aim of the subject of history in the Greek Cypriot history curriculum for primary education, in use since 1994 when the DISY right wing government was in power, reads:

> The aim of the subject of history is to help pupils to become familiar, appreciate the historical life and cultural heritage of Cyprus and Greece, and construct a *national consciousness as members of the Greek nation* and as citizens of a *semi-occupied Cyprus*.[84]

School history aims are then broken down to objectives that are more specific; it is stated for example, that children need:

> …To become conscious of the fact that the Greeks in Greece and Cyprus *prefer death* rather than slavery. …To understand that Cypriots have *preserved* … their *national identity* because they always spoke the Greek language, stayed focused on their *orthodox faith* and … were always taught the Greek letters. …To express their appreciation for the support and help that Greece has been offering to the *struggle* of *Cypriot* people; and to understand the importance of Greece and Cyprus' common struggle *today*.[85]

The history curriculum for secondary education states:

> The subject of history is mainly a humanitarian subject and its general aim, that is, the construction of a historical consciousness and the development of historical thinking *is in absolute harmony with the wider aim of Cypriot education* that refers to the preparation of fulfilled/whole and active citizens.[86]

Thus both the general and specific aims of the history curriculum have a dual emphasis, that of preservation of Helleno-Christian orthodox ideals and that of struggle against occupation. To

[83] For more information, see the website of the Ministry of Education and Culture of the Republic of Cyprus, Secondary Education, available at: http://www.schools.ac.cy/eyliko/mesi/themata/istoria/istoria-gym-index.html

[84] Ministry of Education and Culture of Cyprus, ibid

[85] Ministry of Education and Culture of Cyprus, *Βοήθημα για το δάσκαλο* (Guidelines for the Teacher), Λευκωσία: Υπουργείο Παιδείας και Πολιτισμού, Υπηρεσία Ανάπτυξης Προγραμμάτων, (1987), 94, 98, 138.

[86] Ministry of Education and Culture of Cyprus, *Αναλυτικά Προγράμματα Μέσης Εκπαίδευσης για την Α΄ Τάξη Ενιαίου Λυκείου, Κοινού Κορμού, Ιστορία Αρχαίας Ελλάδας - Κύπρου [Secondary Education Curricula for the A΄ Grade of Lyceum, History of Ancient Greece – Cyprus),* Λευκωσία: Υπουργείο Παιδείας και Πολιτισμού, Υπηρεσία Ανάπτυξης Προγραμμάτων, (in press) (my emphasis).

illustrate this point Maratheftis and later Christou argued that the goal of the Greek-Cypriot educational system has been the preservation of our national and cultural identity by educating the new generation about the occupied part while at the same time promoting ecumenical values such as 'humanism, justice, freedom and democracy'.[87] After the invasion, the phrase 'I don't Forget and I Struggle '[88] began to decorate every single classroom in Cyprus. The purpose of the educational system was, and still is, to heighten pupils' awareness of the political problem. However, Christou's findings show that recent history and especially the internal conflict that preceded 1974 is rarely if ever included in history lessons. Pupils in her research argued that they had almost finished high school without being exposed to any explanation about the events that have taken place in their country in the last 50 years. Their grievances were two-pronged: on the one hand, they complained about a heavy emphasis on the 'ancient' history of Cyprus and on the other hand about inadequate weight given to the more recent events on the island. According to Hadjipavlou, national ideology, cultivated in Greek-Cypriot schools, stresses, among other issues, historical heroism and sacrifice of those who died to liberate the island from its many conquerors, especially from the Ottoman and the British Empires:

> The youth is often given the example of how a handful of young idealists put up a fight against an entire Empire! Nowadays, also the enslaved lands occupied by the Turkish barbarian boot in 1974 call upon the young generation not to forget and prepare to honour the heroic deeds of Greek fighters and thus liberate the land from the foreign army. [89]

One of the most important tools for implementing the dual aim of the Greek-Cypriot curriculum is the textbook. A single-textbook policy is followed, with textbooks produced in Greece by the Organisation of Greek Didactic Books and the Department for Curriculum Development Programmes of the Ministry of Education and Culture in Cyprus. A convincing analysis of the ideological orientations of these books has identified significant characteristics of the historical narratives: historical continuity, preservation, homogeneity and unity of the national group as well as attitudes of superiority towards oriental others, and ambiguous attitudes towards westerners. [90] Similar characteristics may be identified in all textbooks produced in Cyprus,

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[87] Miranda Christou, "Challenging pedagogy: Greek Cypriot youth and the teaching of history" (paper presented at the Bi-Communal, Interdisciplinary Conference of the Center for the Study of Childhood and Adolescence, Ledra Palace, Nicosia, 16 October 2004).

[88] In Greek: *Δεν Ξεχνώ και Αγωνίζομαι* (*Dhen Ksechno kai Agonizomai*).

[89] Maria Hadjipavlou (note 53).

[90] Anna Fragoudaki and Thalia Dragona, *Τι είν' η πατρίδα μας; Εθνοκεντρισμός στην εκπαίδευση. [What is our country: Ethnocentrism in education]* (Αθήνα: Αλεξάνδρεια, 1997, 344-400). See also, First name Couloumparitsis, Δυσνόητο περιεχόμενο στα σχολικά βιβλία ιστορίας: Μεθοδολογικές υποδείξεις για τη διδασκαλία και την κατανόησή τους [Difficult to understand content in school history textbooks: methodological suggestions for their teaching and understanding], *Παιδαγωγική Επιθεώρηση [Pedagogical Review]*, 22 (1995): 283-292; Ian Davies, "Education for European citizenship and the teaching and learning of history," in *Teaching for citizenship in Europe,* Stoke-on-Trent, eds. Audrey *Osler*, Hanns-Fred *Rathenow*, Hugh *Starkey*, editors. (Stoke-on-Trent: Trentham Books, 1995), 149-160; Thalia Dragonas and Anna Fragoudaki, "The persistence of ethnocentric school history," in *Teaching the history of southeastern Europe,* ed. Christina Koulouri (Thessaloniki: Center for Democracy and Reconciliation in Southeast Europe, 2001), 37-47; Georgios Flouris and Pella Calogiannaki, Εθνοκεντρισμός και εκπαίδευση: Η περίπτωση των Βαλκάνιων λαών και Τούρκων στα ελληνικά σχολικά βιβλία. Αφορμή για προβληματισμό και συζήτηση [Ethnocentrism and education; the case of Balkan peoples and Turks in Greek textbooks; an opportunity for reflection and discussion], *Παιδαγωγική Επιθεώρηση (Pedagogical Review),* 23 (1996): 207-248; Panayiotis Xochellis et al., Η εικόνα του 'άλλου' στα σχολικά εγχειρίδια των Βαλκανικών χωρών [The image of the 'other' in the school textbooks of the Balkan countries], *Νέα Παιδεία (New Pedagogy)*, 87 (1998): 59-88; Loris Koullapis, Ιδεολογικοί προσανατολισμοί της

where the history of the island is presented as part of Greek national history and terms such as 'Greek' and 'Cypriot' are used interchangeably or synonymously.[91]

5.2.1 History textbooks content and ideological controversy

Despite their different political goals, the two nationalisms that emerged in Cyprus shared the same form, namely, an ethnic nationalism[92] stressing common history, descent, language, culture and religion with the people of the "motherlands" Turkey and Greece. Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots were only taught the history of Greece and the history of Turkey respectively, while the history of Cyprus was only relatively recently introduced and with considerably less time allotted.[93] On the Greek Cypriot side, the history of Cyprus has been presented as an extension of the history of Greece, and on the Turkish Cypriot side as an extension of the history of Turkey.[94]

The general framework and basic principles of the Greek Cypriot schoolbooks are derived from the dominant model of the history of Greece. This model posits three key periods: ancient Greece, medieval Greece (the Byzantine Empire), and modern Greece (the creation of the Greek state during the 19th and 20th centuries). Emphasis is placed on ancient Greece as the beginning of history, succeeded by "foreign domination" until the rise of the Byzantine Empire (treated as a glorious "Greek" empire) and finally liberation from the "Turkish yoke."[95] "Hellenism" is the transcendental, trans-historical category informing this historical discourse, which posits the historical continuity of Hellenism from ancient to modern times. Turks emerge as Hellenism's barbaric archenemy according to this historical narrative.

"Cyprus is and has been Greek and nothing but Greek" is the message conveyed by the cover of the major Greek Cypriot primary-level schoolbook on the history of Cyprus, which shows a row of ancient columns; as for its people: "Cypriots were and are Christian Orthodox."[96] This book

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ελληνοκυπριακής εκπαίδευσης με έμφαση στο μάθημα της Ιστορίας [Ideological orientations of the Greek-Cypriot education with emphasis on the subject of History], *Σύγχρονα Θέματα*, 70 (1999): 276-296, Stavroula Philippou, "The European dimension in education and pupils' identity: A study of the impact of a primary school curricular intervention in Cypru*"* (Unpublished doctoral thesis, Cambridge: University of Cambridge, 2004a.)

91 Maria Hadjipavlou, "Cyprus: A partnership between conflict resolution and peace education," in *Peace education: The concept, principles, and practices around the world*, eds. Gavriel *Salomon*, Baruch *Nevo*; (Mahwah, NJ: Lawrence Earlbaum Associates, 2002), 193-208; Niyiazi Kizilyurek, "National memory and Turkish-Cypriot textbooks," in *Clio in the Balkans; The Politics of history education,* ed. Christina Koulouri (Thessaloniki: Center for Democracy and Reconciliation in Southeast Europe, 2002), 431-442; Loris Koullapis, The subject of history in the Greek-Cypriot education system; A subset of the Greek nation. In Koulouri, ibid.

92 Anthony Smith, *National Identity* (Harmondsworth: Penguin, 1991).

93 Koullapis, "Ideologikoi Prosanatolismoi"; and Kizilyrek, "National Memory" (note 1).

94 Koullapis, "The Subject of History"; Kizilyrek, "National Memory", (note 1).

95 For comprehensive critical discussions of Greek history schoolbooks see Anna Frangoudaki and Thalia Dragona (note 90). For critical comparative discussions of Greek and Turkish schoolbooks see: Iraklis Millas, *Eikones Ellinon kai Tourkon: Scholika Vivlia, Istoriografia, Logotechnia kai Ethnika Stereotypa* (Images of Greeks and Turks: Schoolbooks, Historiography, Literature and National Stereotypes) (Athens: Alexandria, 2001); Loris Koullapis, "The Presentation of the Period 1071-1923 in Greek and Turkish Textbooks Between 1950-2000," *International Textbook Research* 24, no. 3 (2002): 279-304.

96 Andreas Polydorou, *Istoria tis Kyprou* (History of Cyprus) (Nicosia: A.P. Publications, 1991), 58. That the cover photo actually shows Roman columns (as the book indicates inside) is a point that primary school students could hardly grasp since columns are immediately associated with ancient Greek monuments. For the most detailed critiques of this book, which also support the findings presented here see: AKTI, *Ekthesi gia ta Vivlia Istorias*; Kalypso Charalampous and Elena Mihi, *O Ethnikos Eaftos kai o Ethnikos Allos sto Egheiridio Istorias Andrea*

covers the Roman period to the present, thus presenting the most complete narrative of the whole of the history of Cyprus in primary school.[97] From the start it subsumes the history of Cyprus within the history of Greece with the two first sections entitled "The Conquest of Greece by the Romans" followed by "The Conquest of Cyprus by the Romans." This and the other Greek Cypriot schoolbooks to be discussed follow the periodisation of history, a precedent established for recounting the history of Greece, by presenting history "from above" as a succession of empires/rulers with the adjective *–kratia* (domination) signifying oppression, used for everyone but (ancient) Greeks or Byzantines, as in *Frangokratia*, *Enetokratia*, *Tourkokratia*, *Agglokratia* (Frankish, Venetian, Turkish, and English Domination). In all the books, "Cypriot Hellenism" is the central actor of history from beginning to end.

All the books employ the term Cypriots (*Kyprioi*) as equivalent to Greeks (*Ellines*), often within the same sentence or paragraph. As Koullapis rightly argued, "this practice inculcates in the historical consciousness of Greek Cypriots the belief that from the period of the Mycenaeans to the present there have never been any other indigenous population groups except the Greeks or, at the very least, that the presence of any Others was and is parasitic." [98] As a secondary-level schoolbook states in the foreword: "Many peoples passed over Cyprus or conquered her… But its inhabitants safeguarded its Hellenic character created since the Mycenaeans settled in Cyprus…"[99] This "Hellenisation thesis," reproduced in all relevant schoolbooks, has attracted considerable academic critique, although mainly from outside Cyprus.[100] According to the logic of this model, others (Turkish Cypriots, for example) have (historically speaking) no rightful place in Cyprus; hence the category "Cypriots" is constantly used in a manner that excludes them. As the previous quote indicates, the arrival of the Mycenaeans is considered the most important historical event that has sealed the Hellenic character of Cyprus.

Just as, according to the logic of ethnic nationalism, the Byzantines are treated as Greeks, the Ottomans are presented as Turks, with the primary-level schoolbook containing a section on "The Conquest of Nicosia by the Turks" – beginning as follows: "It was obvious that one day the Turks would try to grab Cyprus. The way that the state of the Sultan expanded, little Cyprus appeared like a weak mouse in the claws of a wild lion."[101] This sets the tone regarding the Turks, who appear as an expansionist and bestially savage people. It is worth noting here that the author of this textbook has recently publicly made a self critic and admitted that his book was biased in favour of GREEK CYPRIOTs since he omitted the wrongs done by the GREEK CYPRIOT community to the TURKISH CYPRIOT community in the period from 1963-1974.

The Ottoman period is presented in this and other schoolbooks in exclusively negative terms: "As a part of the Ottoman Empire, Cyprus followed the fate of the rest of Hellenism. Insults,

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Polydorou (The National Self and National Other in the History Schoolbook of Andreas Polydorou), (unpublished study for the requirements of the Master in Education, University of Cyprus, Nicosia, 2006). I would like to note that this and all other translations from Greek or Turkish are my own.

97 Earlier historical periods are covered in previous primary school classes.

98 Koullapis, "Ideologikoi Prosanatolismoi", (note 1),283. As Koullapis also argues, this practice has been employed in all history books. For examples of this practice see Polydorou, *Istoria tis Kyprou*, 91, 107, 108, 110.

99 YAP (*Ypiresia Anaptyxis Programmaton*), *Istoria tis Kyprou, Neolithiki –Romaiki* [History of Cyprus, Neolithic-Roman] (Λευκωσία: Υπουργείο Παιδείας και Πολιτισμού, Υπηρεσία Ανάπτυξης Προγραμμάτων, 2005), 2.

100 For a general outline of the arguments and critiques see Natasha Leriou, "Constructing an Archaeological Narrative: The Hellenisation of Cyprus," *Stanford Journal of Archaeology*, 1 (2002):1-32.

101 Polydorou, *Istoria tis Kyprou* (note 96), 69.

humiliations, oppression."[102] In contrast, the Byzantine administration is shown in a positive light with "Byzantine civilization flourishing."[103] Given that for Turkish Cypriots the ascription "Turks" is constantly employed,[104] this presents them as part of the larger historical category of Turks, who are shown as a bloodthirsty, hostile and barbaric people.

The Turkish Cypriot school textbooks[105] used until 2004 follow the same logic of ethnic nationalism, with the problems previously identified for Greek Cypriot books now amplified, to the extent that these textbooks could themselves provide textbook examples of all that can go wrong with a history textbook. These books present the history of Cyprus as nothing but part of Turkish history. History begins with the arrival of the Ottomans in Cyprus, the most important historical event as it was the event that sealed its character, "to such an extent that Cyprus with today's numerous Turkish monuments has preserved its 'Turkish Character.'"[106] If history begins with the Ottoman conquest of Cyprus in 1571, then according to this logic Cyprus has been Turkish for three quarters of its history (until the British take-over in 1878). The Ottoman period is glorified as a time of freedom and progress, with long lists and descriptions of Ottoman public works and monuments in Cyprus. The period that receives most emphasis in the books is 1963-1974, presented as a homogeneous barbaric onslaught of "Rums" against the "Turks" in Cyprus, all part of a plan (the Akritas Plan, a Greek Cypriot-inspired plan which aimed to bring about Union with Greece, by force if necessary, whose origins and implementation are still disputed) aiming to eradicate the "Turks," this being a period when the "Rums" displayed "such savagery and barbarism that the world has seldom seen."[107]

Since the same model of ethnic nationalism is followed, the two histories share the same structure and underlying assumptions. Both uncritically treat the nation as ever- present while the historical and, following this logic, the political existence of others is disputed. History is constructed through black and white, good and evil, homogeneous categories. And as Orwell commented long ago: "The nationalist not only does not disapprove of atrocities committed by his own side, but he has a remarkable capacity for not even hearing about them."[108] Both are histories "from above," telling the stories of great men, and focusing more on the change of dynasties, on diplomatic and political history, and giving scant attention to social history, internal differences (whether political, class or gender ones) or internal violence, interactions and cooperation. War is so pervasive that it emerges as the motor of history to the point where it becomes naturalized as an immutable human characteristic. Both approaches exalt the nation-ethnos placing it at the centre of the narratives; both reject the conceptualization of Cyprus as a multicultural and multi-ethnic space in the past and the present.

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[102] YAP, *Istoria tis Kyprou, Gymnasio* [History of Cyprus, Gymnasium] (Nicosia: Publisher, 2005), 92.

[103] YAP, *Istoria tis Kyprou, Gymnasio*, 66. On the contrasting presentations of the Byzantine period and Ottoman period in Greek schoolbooks as "paradise" and "hell" and vice versa in Turkish schoolbooks, see Koullapis, "The Presentation of the Period 1071-1923."

[104] With the exception that there are rare mentions of "Turkish Cypriots" at the very end of the books.

[105] Yiannis Papadakis, *History Education in Divided Cyprus: A Comparison of Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot Schoolbooks on the "History of Cyprus*" (Oslo: International Peace Research Institute, 2008) PRIO Report 2/2008. Available at http://www.prio.no/upload/Report-History%20Education%20low.pdf

[106] Ibid., 7. (note 105)

[107] Ibid., 114. (note 105)

[108] George Orwell, *Essays* (London: Penguin Classic, 2000), 307.

Immediately following its 2003 election victory, the left-wing CTP (Republican Turkish Party) called for a complete rewrite of school history books. Accordingly, in 2004 (and revised in 2005), three new books covering the history of Cyprus from the arrival of its first inhabitants to the present were published. This party as well as its supporters were pro reunification and critical of Turkey[109] – which is why it soon changed the history books that clearly promoted the opposite goals. In contrast to the Turko-centrism of the Right, the Left was Cyprio-centric and leaned more towards a model of *civic nationalism*[110] prioritizing the geopolitical space of Cyprus and expressing affinity with all its inhabitants, in the hope that a joint state would one day materialize.

The period 1963-1974, which the earlier books presented in a uniform manner as a period of Greek Cypriot barbarism ("Dark Years"), is now broken into two sections, with 1963-1967 as the "Difficult Years" and 1967-1974 up to the coup as "A New Period for Cyprus."[111] This period now emerges as only a small part of the whole (three-volume) History of Cyprus, in contrast to the previous books where it was the most emphasized. Gruesome descriptions are now avoided, and where violence against Turkish Cypriots is indicated, it is noted that it was carried out by "certain" Greek Cypriots.[112] Similarly, throughout the books, ethnic groups are not portrayed as homogeneous, but rather internal divides and conflicts are often presented. For the 20th century for example, Greek Cypriots are shown as split between the Right (including the Church) and Left (especially AKEL),[113] or later between those supporting Makarios and the EOKA B.[114] Turkish Cypriots, likewise, are shown as having been divided into two groups, the Traditionalists and the Kemalists.[115] Also included are indications of internal violence among Turkish Cypriots, with TMT described as having sometimes been used "for the settlement of personal scores and some of its activities caused reactions among Turkish Cypriots."[116] TMT is no longer presented as an organization of glorious heroes, but more as a necessary evil to counter EOKA and Greek nationalism and to protect Turkish Cypriots. Similarly, Turkish nationalism in Cyprus is presented in a negative light but as a historical reaction to Greek nationalism.

History is no longer presented as a monolithic story of conflict; instead, conscious emphasis is placed on examples of coexistence and cooperation, and there is a shift from political and diplomatic history towards social, cultural and economic history.[117] Many examples are presented, from the Ottoman period to the present, when cooperation was an aspect of daily life – from common workers' struggles, to music, football and trade, and mundane events like simply

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[109] Yiannis Papadakis, *Echoes from the Dead Zone: Across the Cyprus Divide* (London: I. B. Tauris, 2005), 185-206.

[110] Anthony Smith (note 92). It should be noted that ethnic and civic nationalism are ideal-type descriptions and there may often be common ground between the two. The latter, for example, may include an ethnic emphasis on indigenous populations corresponding to a territory, thus excluding migrants.

[111] Ibid, 92-113, 114-121.

[112] Ibid, 126.

[113] AKEL (Progressive Party of the Working People) is a communist party that has commanded significant popular support among Greek Cypriots and was often critical of the nationalist policies of the Greek Cypriot Right.

[114] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 3*, 54, 84, 118-119.

[115] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 2*, 76-77.

[116] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 3*, 64.

[117] POST (note 80)

eating and drinking together.[118] Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots are shown to suffer together, from heavy taxation imposed by the British for example,[119] and as dying together when they served in the joint Cypriot contingent of the British Army during World War II.[120] Muslims and Christians are presented as staging joint revolts during the Ottoman period, while instances of cooperation between the leadership of the Orthodox Church and the Ottoman authorities are also highlighted.[121] The 1962 murders of two Turkish Cypriot journalists supporting cooperation between Turkish Cypriots and Greek Cypriots are castigated as violent attacks against voices for peace and cooperation.[122] The period of rapprochement between Atatürk and Venizelos, the prime minister of Greece, is presented in these books, in contrast to previous ones, as an exemplary time,[123] with Atatürk's dictum "Peace at Home, Peace in the World" also prominently displayed at the beginning of each book under his photograph.

The books remain to a significant extent ethnocentric, though now from a Turkish Cypriot rather than Turkish perspective, due to more coverage of issues like social life, monuments and culture, press and political personalities provided for the Turkish Cypriot community. Also characteristic is that, while the two communities are shown as sharing the blame, a larger portion is allocated to the Greek Cypriots. Gender differences are still not adequately accounted for; nor are the smaller communities of Armenians, Maronites and Latins (Roman Catholics), and past and present migration movements. Despite these general weaknesses, and others that a team of historical specialists on different periods could potentially identify, the new books, based on contemporary trends of historical analysis and teaching, represent a positive and subversive move away from the old model.

5.3 Methods and use of media

The pedagogical approach followed in the history textbooks (of both Greece/Turkey and Cyprus) in Cyprus, across the divide generally reflects the monoperspective view of history and the absence of historical enquiry. The main teaching approach used in relation to history teaching is one that could be described as based on a transmission of beliefs from the teacher to the student[124]. In the Greek Cypriot textbooks each chapter of the textbook follows a principal narrative which is the dominant feature. It is assumed that concepts are understood without having to be explained in depth.[125] Key-concepts or core knowledge supporting historical thought, which could form a basis for further elaboration and understanding of both history and other areas of learning, are not constructed or pursued. Written sources, maps and images are

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[118] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 2*, 32, 39; MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 3*, 22, 32, 46-48, 51, 110-111.
[119] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 3*, 19.
[120] Ibid., 21.
[121] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 2*, 31-32.
[122] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 3*, 86.
[123] MEKB, *Kıbrıs Tarihi 2*, 74.
[124] Chara Makriyianni and Charis Psaltis (note 44).
[125] Stavoula Philippou, "Developing a European dimension in education: The case of Byzantine history in primary curricula in Cyprus," in *What Does It Mean to Think Historically? Approaches to teaching and learning history,* eds. Stavroula Philippou and Chara Makriyianni (Nicosia: Association for Historical Dialogue and Research, 2004b), 93; Tryfonas Skouros, Η κατάκτηση των αφηγηματικών ιστορικών εννοιών από τους Ελληνοκύπριους μαθητές της έκτης δημοτικού (11-12) [The acquisition of the narrative historical concepts by GreekCypriot pupils of the sixth form of primary school (11-12)], *Παιδαγωγική Επιθεώρηση***,** 29(1999): 147-168.

included; however, both sources and main text offer a unified interpretation. Questions and activities mostly demand repetition, offering no opportunity for in-depth,multi-perspective[126] enquiries or open-ended investigations. The development of historical skills and critical thinking is thus not actively promoted by the form, content and organisation of textbooks. Most questions/activities focus on cognitive-factual knowledge and are based on ideological assumptions of which textbook authors themselves may be unaware.

A phenomenon noted in the Greek Cypriot community is the disjunction between theoretical knowledge of constructivist epistemologies/ student centred approaches and actual practice in the classroom that tends to be more traditional and teacher-centred.[127] A similar gap is noted between the pedagogical guidelines issued by the educational authorities stressing that in order to achieve the aims and objectives of history education, it is vital that the teacher adopts active, cooperative learning methods such as: enquiry-based methods, problem-solving, taking decisions on moral dilemmas, dramas and role plays, debates, as well as the use of various modern teaching tools such as videotapes, educational CD-ROMs, DVDs.[128] Guidelines in both primary and the secondary history curriculum recommend that, during his/her lesson, a teacher should make good use of school history textbooks and other books, maps and modern visual aids. Lessons need to be organised in a pragmatic way so that a student is given an opportunity to analyse, judge, compare, become aware, discuss and try to find solutions to problems, to promote creative thinking and to develop particular skills and abilities. A cross-curricular and diachronic approach of topics is encouraged whenever the teacher thinks appropriate, as well as visits to museums and archaeological or historical sites, once the teacher feels the pupils are adequately prepared.

It is worth mentioning that, through information technology, there are online databases with lesson plans and materials for primary school and secondary school[129] but the material uploaded at the Ministry's web pages in relation to the events of the periods 1964-1974 do not challenge the dominant official narrative[130]. Secondary education has concentrated more on the production of CDs on the History of Cyprus with encyclopaedic information, activities and visual material on archaeology[131].

The Ministry of Education and Culture of the Republic of Cyprus has a Museum Education policy regarding organised visits to certain archaeological and historical museums and sites. For Secondary Education there is a series of educational booklets that can be photocopied by

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[126] Term used here to mean: multiple perspectives and multiple intepretations. See Robert Stradling, *Multiperspectivity in history teaching: A guide for teachers* (Strasbourg: Council of Europe, 2003).

[127] Mairy Koutselini and Panayiotis Persianis, 'Theory-practice Divide in Teacher Education at the University of Cyprus and the Role of the Traditional Values of the Orthodox Church," *Teaching in Higher Education,* Vol. 5 (2000): 501-520.

[128] One such CD/DVD aiming at the in the integration of IT technology in History teaching at the elementary school was recently produced by the Pedagogical Institute in the south.

[129] http://www.schools.ac.cy/klimakio/Themata/Istoria/index.html
http://www.schools.ac.cy/eyliko/mesi/themata/istoria/istoria-gym-index.html
http://www.schools.ac.cy/eyliko/mesi/themata/istoria/istoria-lyc-index.html

[130] http://www.schools.ac.cy/eyliko/mesi/themata/istoria/pdf/his17.pdf
http://www.schools.ac.cy/eyliko/mesi/themata/istoria/pdf/his18.pdf

[131] http://www.schools.ac.cy/klimakio/Themata/Istoria/cd_cyprus_history/index.html

teachers and used for work on site. There are also museum packs that can be borrowed from the Cyprus Pedagogical Institute and used at school. For Primary Education there are museum educational programmes conducted and organised by teachers on secondment, in Archaeological and Social History Museums and Art Galleries in Larnaka, Famagusta, Limassol, Paphos and Nicosia. It should also be noted that the participation in educational programmes organised by semi- or non-governmental organisations with museum collections, is also encouraged. Next to the programmes animated by seconded educators, visits in the form of guided tours to museums, such as the Museum of the EOKA anti-colonial Struggle 1955-1959, are encouraged by the Ministry as well as pilgrimage visits to the burial places of EOKA fighters. The differences in the pedagogical approach between this museum and the archaeological museum were found to be stark, and this is largely due to the contrasting aims of each Museum (critical thinking versus promotion of national pride) and also due to the fact that the aforementioned educational programmes are animated by educators of the Ministry of Education and Culture with post-graduate studies in museum education and/or history teaching[132].

In the Turkish Cypriot community, history education taught via the old Cyprus history textbooks did not provide students with any space to think, analyse, and interpret events from different perspectives. However, the new Cyprus history textbooks are different on this point; they encourage students to de-centre from the Turkish nationalist narrative, at least when it comes to the history of Cyprus. The revised textbooks of Cyprus history of the CTP administration contain different kind of sources, like accounts of people who took part in events, photographs, drawings, caricatures. Visual images contained in all three books are informative; they are used as an additional learning tool, help to further explain and highlight important points and attempt to provide a balanced view of Cyprus.[133] Moreover, and whilst in traditional education the 'teacher speaks and the students listen', in the new textbooks there are many instances in which students are encouraged to think, analyse the given information and discuss the subject. The use of caricatures attracts students' attention and encourages their participation; studying history can be fun. The new textbooks also differ from the old books in terms of their aesthetics, especially in the use of colour. The old textbooks where printed in black and white, the paper quality was poor and the books contained very few pictures. Last but not least, there is a vast difference between the old books' approach and the new ones, in terms of references. The new textbooks' draw on more up to date references, and interestingly, the writers of the new textbooks were not apprehensive in using Greek and/or Greek Cypriot writers. In contrast, Vehbi Zeki Serter's book used only one Greek Cypriot writer as a reference. In line with the nationalist ideology sometimes visits by schools are arranged to the *Museum of barbarism* and the Museum of Struggle[134] despite the reaction against this practice by the powerful Turkish-Cypriot Teacher Trade Unions KTOS (primary school teachers) and KTOEOS (secondary school teachers).

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[132] Chara Makriyianni, (note 47).

[133] POST(note 80).

[134] Chara Makriyianni, (note 47); Yiannis Papadakis, "The National Struggle Museums of a Divided City," *Ethnic and Racial Studies*, Vol. 17, No. 3 (1994): 400-419; Debbie Lisle, (2005). Encounters with partition: Tourism and Reconcilliation in Cyprus,CIBR Working papers in border studies (available at http://www.qub.ac.uk/cibr/WPpdffiles/CIBRwp2007_1.pdf).

6. Conclusion and outlook

The present review of the situation of history teaching in Cyprus, in both communities, reveals the constraining influence that the unresolved Cyprus issue and competing ethnic Greek and Turkish nationalism is having on the modernisation of the teaching of history. The efforts to solve the Cyprus issue and international politics had and will probably also in the future have an influence in the process of history reform but we should keep in mind that the main guiding force in this effort should not be politics but academic history and the pedagogical science of history didactics that is disciplined and research based. The effort of educational reform should be to disengage itself from identity politics and to aspire to transform students' understanding of the world through the teaching of *how* to study the past and think historically. Understanding the past helps students understand the world, gives meaning to their present and helps them to have a glance to the future, not in the sense of predicting it, but 'preventing it from abusing them'. As AHDR recently proposed:[135]

> History education should not be a tool for political manipulation conveying a fixed version of the past, or promoting political and ideological agendas. It should be a means in itself helping students navigate their lives in an informed and critical manner with an enhanced sense of agency and critical thinking. In order to promote students' historical thinking and understanding, a complete reform on history education in Cyprus, informed by educational research, is needed. This reform should be based on the understanding that history education is primarily about developing concepts and dispositions that are essential part of the discipline of history.

History education, can help students to develop their reflective skills, the knowledge and mental tools that are necessary to understand the contemporary, and future world in which they are going to live as adults.

A necessary condition for the achievement of these long term project is however to disengage history teaching from ethnocentric biases and open it up to multiple perspectives both inside each community and outside Cyprus, incorporating such perspectives in European and International history. The disciplinary approach to history in other words presupposes a liberal and anti-authoritarian disposition of impartiality, democracy of the sources, historical empathy, perspective taking and openness to dialogue. From this perspective, it is no wonder that persons and institutions dealing seriously with the advancement of history teaching like AHDR find themselves in the third spaces of inter-communal and international dialogue and co-operation.

The teaching of history in Cypriot schools is unfortunately up to now largely based on the suppression of the other's perspective on the Cyprus problem and promotes a mono-perspectival, nationalistic take of the past a form of representation that Serge Moscovici would call *social representations based on belief* and not *social representations based on knowledge*[136]. This has two major negative consequences in Cypriot society.

First, it has been a great hindrance in the efforts to create trust between the two communities. In fact by suppressing the others pain and by presenting a mono-perspectival view of history

[135] The whole proposal can be found in English, Turkish and Greek on the webpage of AHDR (http://www.hisdialresearch.org).

[136] Makriyianni and Psaltis (note 71).

results, as recent research has shown[137], in the domination of perspectives on the Cyprus problem that create a phobic, authoritarian and competitive society that ends up in introversion in communal identities and the consolidation of partition by suffocating actual contact and co-operation between the two communities.

Last, but not least, it has also led to poor history teaching since ethnocentrism is translated as an epistemological project based on the transmission of beliefs and the suppression of the quest for knowledge.[138] This impoverished sense of history teaching as mere catechism, leads to blind allegiance to dogmas of faith, having detrimental effects to the critical thinking[139] (cognitive and moral development of our pupils in other words undermining social cohesion and our future as respectable partners in the international community.

6.1 The way forward

As suggested by AHDR[140] an educational reform in both communities of history teaching is in order. In order to equip teachers with the tools and knowledge, for a successful reform of history teaching certain actions should be taken:

a. Include the subject of history education in initial teacher training, taught by educators specialised in history education.

b. Offer systematic in-service teacher training about current developments, research findings and best practices in history education from all over the world.

c. Employ the experience and expertise of the Association of Historical Dialogue and Research, and other organisations such as the Council of Europe and EUROCLIO.

d. Offer post graduate university degrees in the field of history education.

e. Form history advisory groups, comprised by teachers specialised in history education, under the auspices of educational authorities (similar to the groups that already exist for other subjects) to provide support to teachers who teach history (visit schools to guide teachers, organise training seminars, gather, produce and disseminate high-quality supplementary material etc.).

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[137] Charis Psaltis and Chara Makriyianni, "Historical dialogue and Reconciliation in Cyprus" (PRIO 2009 Annual Confeence: Learning from Comparing Conflicts and Reconciliation Processes: A Holistic Approach, 18-20 June 2009, Ledra Palace, Nicosia)

[138] Charis Psaltis, "Communication and the Construction of Knowledge or Transmission of Belief: The Role of Conversation Type, Behavioural Style and Social Recognition," *Studies in Communication Sciences* 5 (2005): 209-228; Charis Psaltis and Duveen Duveen, "Conversation types and conservation: Forms of recognition and cognitive development,".*British Journal of Developmental Psychology 25,*(2007): 79-102; Charis Psaltis and First name Duveen, "Social Relations and Cognitive Development: The Influence of Conversation Type and Representations of Gender," *European Journal of Social Psychology 36* (2006)*:* 407- 430.

[139] Penny Enslin, Should nation building be an aim of education? *Journal of Education 19 (1994):* 23-36.

[140] AHDR proposal available at http://www.hisdialresearch.org/news/AHDR_%20REFORM_PROPOSAL_ENGLISH.pdf

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[141] There are no specialized magazines on didactics of history published in Cyprus.

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